

Space–Time Algebra

A compact development of paravectors and their physical applications

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Abstract

This document develops a three-generator sigma algebra and its complex paravectors, then applies them to relativity, electromagnetism, and quantum mechanics. Natural units $\hbar = c = 1$ and signature $(+, -, -, -)$ are used.

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1 The algebra at a glance

The generators σ_n are algebraic objects with ordered multiplication rules. They are not ordinary vector components: their products generally do not commute, so the order of the factors is part of every expression. The following panel previews the generators, their product, and the general complex element developed below.

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_n^2 &= 1, & \sigma_n \sigma_m &= -\sigma_m \sigma_n \quad (n \neq m), \\ \mathbf{i} &= \sigma_1 \sigma_2 \sigma_3, & \mathbf{i}^2 &= -1, \\ \boldsymbol{\sigma} &= \{\sigma_1, \sigma_2, \sigma_3\}, & \mathbf{i}\boldsymbol{\sigma} &= \{\sigma_2 \sigma_3, \sigma_3 \sigma_1, \sigma_1 \sigma_2\}, \\ Z &= (a + b\mathbf{i}) + (\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B}\mathbf{i}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, & a, b \in \mathbb{R}, \quad \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \in \mathbb{R}^3. \end{aligned}$$

Ordinary three-vector operations use

$$\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B} = A_1 B_1 + A_2 B_2 + A_3 B_3, \quad (1.1)$$

$$\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B} = \{A_2 B_3 - A_3 B_2, A_3 B_1 - A_1 B_3, A_1 B_2 - A_2 B_1\}, \quad (1.2)$$

$$\mathbf{A}^2 := \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{A}. \quad (1.3)$$

Thus the square of a vector always denotes its self dot product.

The set $\{1, \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \mathbf{i}\boldsymbol{\sigma}, \mathbf{i}\}$ is a complete basis, displayed by type as

$$\underbrace{1}_{\text{scalar}}, \quad \underbrace{\sigma_1, \sigma_2, \sigma_3}_{\text{vectors}}, \quad \underbrace{\mathbf{i}\sigma_1, \mathbf{i}\sigma_2, \mathbf{i}\sigma_3}_{\text{bivectors}}, \quad \underbrace{\mathbf{i}}_{\text{pseudoscalar}}.$$

Anticommutation gives $\mathbf{i}^2 = -\sigma_1^2 \sigma_2^2 \sigma_3^2 = -1$. The pseudoscalar is central: moving σ_n through the other two generators produces two sign changes, so

$$\mathbf{i}\sigma_n = \sigma_n \mathbf{i}. \quad (1.4)$$

Thus its order of multiplication does not matter.

The commutator is

$$[X, Y] := XY - YX, \quad [Y, X] = -[X, Y]. \quad (1.5)$$

Thus $[X, Y] = 0$ exactly when X and Y commute. With the Kronecker delta δ_{nm} and Levi-Civita symbol ϵ_{nmk} ,

$$\sigma_n \sigma_m = \delta_{nm} + \epsilon_{nmk} \mathbf{i}\sigma_k, \quad [\sigma_n, \sigma_m] = 2\epsilon_{nmk} \mathbf{i}\sigma_k. \quad (1.6)$$

Repeated spatial indices are summed.

2 Hermitian and sigma-conjugate operators

The Hermitian operator H reverses the order of multiplied sigmas. The sigma-conjugate operator * flips the sign of every sigma without changing their order. Thus, for two generators,

$$(\sigma_m \sigma_n)^H = \sigma_n \sigma_m, \quad (2.1)$$

$$(\sigma_m \sigma_n)^* = (-\sigma_m)(-\sigma_n). \quad (2.2)$$

Both operations act term by term on sums. Their actions on the four basis types are

type representative	scalar 1	vector σ_n	bivector $i\sigma_n$	pseudoscalar i
$(\cdot)^*$	+	−	+	−
$(\cdot)^H$	+	+	−	−
$(\cdot)^{*H}$	+	−	−	+

In particular,

$$\sigma_n^* = -\sigma_n, \quad \sigma_n^H = \sigma_n, \quad i^* = -i, \quad i^H = -i. \quad (2.3)$$

For the bivectors, these actions combine to give

$$(i\sigma_n)^* = i^* \sigma_n^* = i\sigma_n, \quad (i\sigma_n)^H = \sigma_n^H i^H = -i\sigma_n. \quad (2.4)$$

Thus sigma conjugation preserves the original order of the factors, whereas the Hermitian operator changes their order. For arbitrary algebra elements Z, Z' , these definitions give

$$(ZZ')^H = Z'^H Z^H, \quad (ZZ')^* = Z^* Z'^*, \quad Z^{*H} = Z^{H*}.$$

Appendix A reproduces this as Hermitian conjugation in the Pauli-matrix representation.

3 Paravectors

3.1 Core operations

Collect a general complex paravector as

$$\begin{aligned} Z &= (a + bi) + (\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B}i) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} \\ &= X + iY \\ &= S + \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \\ X &:= a + \mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, & Y &:= b + \mathbf{B} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \\ S &:= a + bi, & \mathbf{V} &:= \mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B}i, \end{aligned} \quad (3.1)$$

where $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$ and $\mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \in \mathbb{R}^3$. Define its scalar and vector coefficients by

$$\text{sc}(Z) := S, \quad \text{vec}(Z) := \mathbf{V}. \quad (3.2)$$

Sigma conjugation changes the sign of every sigma generator without changing multiplied order; the Hermitian operator changes multiplied sigma order. For a paravector, define them directly by

$$Z^* := (a - bi) + (-\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B}i) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.3)$$

$$Z^H := (a - bi) + (\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{B}i) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.4)$$

Their composition is the adjugate:

$$\text{adj}(Z) := Z^{*H} = S - \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.5)$$

Define the paravector trace and determinant by

$$\text{tr}(Z) := Z + \text{adj}(Z) = 2S, \quad (3.6)$$

$$\det(Z) := \text{adj}(Z) Z = Z \text{adj}(Z) = S^2 - \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}. \quad (3.7)$$

For any paravectors Z and Z' , the adjugate reverses product order:

$$\text{adj}(ZZ') = \text{adj}(Z') \text{adj}(Z). \quad (3.8)$$

Consequently,

$$\det(ZZ') = \text{adj}(ZZ')ZZ' \quad (3.9)$$

$$= \text{adj}(Z')(\text{adj}(Z)Z)Z' \quad (3.10)$$

$$= \det(Z) \det(Z'). \quad (3.11)$$

Since determinants are scalars,

$$\det(ZZ') = \det(Z'Z). \quad (3.12)$$

Repeated application gives the cyclic property for any finite product; for example,

$$\det(ZZ'Z'') = \det(Z'Z''Z) = \det(Z''ZZ'). \quad (3.13)$$

Whenever $\det(Z) \neq 0$, define

$$Z^{-1} := \frac{\text{adj}(Z)}{\det(Z)}, \quad Z^{-1}Z = ZZ^{-1} = 1. \quad (3.14)$$

For any complex paravector Z and any invertible complex paravector T , the determinant is invariant under either similarity transformation:

$$\det(Z) = \det(T^{-1}ZT) = \det(TZT^{-1}). \quad (3.15)$$

Indeed, the cyclic property gives

$$\det(T^{-1}ZT) = \det(ZTT^{-1}) = \det(Z), \quad (3.16)$$

$$\det(TZT^{-1}) = \det(ZT^{-1}T) = \det(Z). \quad (3.17)$$

Finally, define real and imaginary paravector extraction by

$$\text{re}(Z) := \frac{1}{2}(Z + Z^{\text{H}}) = X, \quad (3.18)$$

$$\text{im}(Z) := \frac{Z - Z^{\text{H}}}{2i} = Y. \quad (3.19)$$

The functions re and im also act componentwise on complex scalars and vectors. The scalar and vector parts are recovered by

$$S = \text{sc}(Z) = \frac{1}{2}(Z + Z^{*\text{H}}), \quad \mathbf{V} = \text{vec}(Z), \quad \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} = \frac{1}{2}(Z - Z^{*\text{H}}). \quad (3.20)$$

The four real coefficients then follow by composition:

$$a = \text{re}(S) = \text{sc}(X) = \text{sc}(\text{re}(Z)), \quad b = \text{im}(S) = \text{sc}(Y) = \text{sc}(\text{im}(Z)), \quad (3.21)$$

$$\mathbf{A} = \text{re}(\mathbf{V}) = \text{vec}(X) = \text{vec}(\text{re}(Z)), \quad \mathbf{B} = \text{im}(\mathbf{V}) = \text{vec}(Y) = \text{vec}(\text{im}(Z)). \quad (3.22)$$

These definitions are intrinsic to the algebra. Appendix A later reproduces them through the faithful Pauli-matrix representation.

3.2 Products and quadratic forms

From the ordered sigma multiplication rule,

$$(\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})(\mathbf{B} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) = \sum_{n,m} A_n B_m \sigma_n \sigma_m \quad (3.23)$$

$$= \sum_{n,m} A_n B_m (\delta_{nm} + \epsilon_{nmk} i \sigma_k) \quad (3.24)$$

$$= \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B} + i(\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} \quad (3.25)$$

$$= 2\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B} - (\mathbf{B} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})(\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}). \quad (3.26)$$

Consequently,

$$(\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})^2 = \mathbf{A}^2, \quad (\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})^{2n} = (\mathbf{A}^2)^n, \quad (\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})^{2n+1} = (\mathbf{A}^2)^n \mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.27)$$

Also,

$$(\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})\boldsymbol{\sigma} = \mathbf{A} + i\mathbf{A} \times \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.28)$$

The corresponding commutator is

$$[\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \mathbf{B} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}] = 2i(\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.29)$$

Hence

$$[\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \boldsymbol{\sigma}] = -2i\mathbf{A} \times \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.30)$$

$$[\mathbf{A} \cdot i\boldsymbol{\sigma}, \boldsymbol{\sigma}] = 2\mathbf{A} \times \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.31)$$

$$[\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \boldsymbol{\sigma}] \cdot \mathbf{B} = 2i(\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.32)$$

For $Z = S + \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$ and $Z' = S' + \mathbf{V}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$,

$$ZZ' = (SS' + \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}') + (S\mathbf{V}' + S'\mathbf{V} + i\mathbf{V} \times \mathbf{V}') \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.33)$$

Thus

$$\text{sc}(ZZ') = SS' + \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}', \quad (3.34)$$

$$\text{vec}(ZZ') = S\mathbf{V}' + S'\mathbf{V} + i\mathbf{V} \times \mathbf{V}'. \quad (3.35)$$

Equivalently, if $Z = X + iY$ and $Z' = X' + iY'$, then

$$ZZ' = (XX' - YY') + i(XY' + YX').$$

For $S = a + bi$ and $\mathbf{V} = \mathbf{A} + B\mathbf{i}$, define the coefficient norms by

$$\|S\|^2 := SS^* = S^*S = a^2 + b^2, \quad (3.36)$$

$$\|\mathbf{V}\|^2 := \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}^* = \mathbf{V}^* \cdot \mathbf{V} = \mathbf{A}^2 + B^2, \quad (3.37)$$

$$\|Z\|^2 := \|S\|^2 + \|\mathbf{V}\|^2. \quad (3.38)$$

The paravector norm may equivalently be written

$$\|Z\|^2 = \text{sc}(Z^H Z) = \text{sc}(Z Z^H) = \text{sc}(Z^* Z^{*H}) = \text{sc}(Z^{*H} Z^*). \quad (3.39)$$

Thus $\det(Z)$ may be complex, whereas $\|Z\|^2$ is real and nonnegative. In general,

$$S^2 \neq \|S\|^2, \quad \mathbf{V}^2 \neq \|\mathbf{V}\|^2. \quad (3.40)$$

For any complex scalar c ,

$$\text{adj}(cZ) = c \text{adj}(Z). \quad (3.41)$$

Therefore

$$\det(cZ) = c^2 \det(Z). \quad (3.42)$$

For real r and θ ,

$$\det(r \exp(i\theta)Z) = r^2 \det(Z) \exp(2i\theta), \quad \text{while} \quad \|r \exp(i\theta)Z\|^2 = r^2 \|Z\|^2. \quad (3.43)$$

3.3 Quadratic identity and eigenvalues

Since $Z - S = \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$ and $(\mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})^2 = \mathbf{V}^2$,

$$(Z - S)^2 = \mathbf{V}^2, \quad (3.44)$$

$$Z^2 - 2SZ + (S^2 - \mathbf{V}^2) = 0. \quad (3.45)$$

Using $\text{tr}(Z) = 2S$ and $\det(Z) = S^2 - \mathbf{V}^2$ gives the equivalent trace-determinant identity

$$Z^2 - \text{tr}(Z)Z + \det(Z) = 0. \quad (3.46)$$

Replacing Z by a scalar eigenvalue λ and solving this quadratic gives

$$\lambda_{\pm} = \frac{\text{tr}(Z) \pm \sqrt{\text{tr}(Z)^2 - 4\det(Z)}}{2} = S \pm \sqrt{\mathbf{V}^2}. \quad (3.47)$$

Because $\mathbf{V}$ is generally complex, $\mathbf{V}^2 = \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}$ and its square root may also be complex. The quadratic identity therefore factors as

$$(Z - \lambda_-)(Z - \lambda_+) = 0. \quad (3.48)$$

3.4 Real products

Let

$$X = a + \mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad Y = b + \mathbf{B} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad a, b \in \mathbb{R}, \quad \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \in \mathbb{R}^3. \quad (3.49)$$

Then

$$XY = (ab + \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B}) + (a\mathbf{B} + b\mathbf{A} + i\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.50)$$

$$\text{sc}(XY) = ab + \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B}, \quad (3.51)$$

$$\text{vec}(XY) = a\mathbf{B} + b\mathbf{A} + i\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}, \quad (3.52)$$

$$[X, Y] = 2i(\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.53)$$

$$X^2 = (a^2 + \mathbf{A}^2) + 2a\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.54)$$

$$\text{sc}(X^2) = a^2 + \mathbf{A}^2, \quad (3.55)$$

$$\text{vec}(X^2) = 2a\mathbf{A}, \quad (3.56)$$

$$X^2 - 2aX + (a^2 - \mathbf{A}^2) = 0, \quad (3.57)$$

$$X^{-1} = \frac{a - \mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}}{a^2 - \mathbf{A}^2}, \quad (3.58)$$

$$d(X^{-1}) = -X^{-1}(dX)X^{-1}. \quad (3.59)$$

The condition $\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B} = 0$ implies $XY = YX$, $X^{-1}Y = YX^{-1}$, and $\det(XY) = \det(Y)\det(X)$.

3.5 Complex products

Let

$$Z = (a + bi) + (\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B}i) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad a, b \in \mathbb{R}, \quad \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \in \mathbb{R}^3, \quad (3.60)$$

and use primes for a second paravector with real primed components. The four real components of ZZ' are

$$\text{real scalar: } aa' - bb' + \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{A}' - \mathbf{B} \cdot \mathbf{B}', \quad (3.61)$$

$$\text{imaginary scalar: } ab' + ba' + \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B}' + \mathbf{B} \cdot \mathbf{A}', \quad (3.62)$$

$$\text{real vector: } a\mathbf{A}' - b\mathbf{B}' + a'\mathbf{A} - b'\mathbf{B} - \mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}' - \mathbf{B} \times \mathbf{A}', \quad (3.63)$$

$$\text{imaginary vector: } a\mathbf{B}' + b\mathbf{A}' + a'\mathbf{B} + b'\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{A}' - \mathbf{B} \times \mathbf{B}'. \quad (3.64)$$

For the important quadratic products:

$$Z^2 : (a^2 - b^2 + \mathbf{A}^2 - \mathbf{B}^2) + 2i(ab + \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B}) + 2(a\mathbf{A} - b\mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} + 2i(a\mathbf{B} + b\mathbf{A}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.65)$$

$$ZZ^*, Z^*Z : (a^2 + b^2 - \mathbf{A}^2 - \mathbf{B}^2) \mp 2(\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} + 2i(a\mathbf{B} - b\mathbf{A}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.66)$$

$$ZZ^H, Z^HZ : a^2 + b^2 + \mathbf{A}^2 + \mathbf{B}^2 + 2(a\mathbf{A} + b\mathbf{B} \pm \mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.67)$$

$$Z \text{ adj}(Z) : a^2 - b^2 - \mathbf{A}^2 + \mathbf{B}^2 + 2i(ab - \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B}). \quad (3.68)$$

The scalar part is cyclic, $\text{sc}(ZZ') = \text{sc}(Z'Z)$. The operator laws already established also give $(ZZ')^{*H} = Z'^{*H}Z^{*H}$. The paired signs follow the displayed product order. Thus $ZZ^* = Z^*Z$ and $ZZ^H = Z^HZ$ precisely when $\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B} = 0$.

3.6 Projection operators

For a real unit vector $\mathbf{u}$, define

$$\Pi_{\pm} := \frac{1}{2}(1 \pm \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}). \quad (3.69)$$

Since $(\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})^2 = 1$,

$$\Pi_{\pm}^2 = \Pi_{\pm}, \quad \Pi_+ \Pi_- = 0, \quad \Pi_+ + \Pi_- = 1, \quad (3.70)$$

$$\Pi_{\pm}^H = \Pi_{\pm}, \quad \Pi_{\pm}^* = \Pi_{\mp}, \quad (\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})\Pi_{\pm} = \pm\Pi_{\pm}. \quad (3.71)$$

Thus $\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} = \Pi_+ - \Pi_-$. For two unit directions,

$$(\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})(\mathbf{u}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) = \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{u}' + i(\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{u}') \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.72)$$

$$[\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \mathbf{u}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}] = 2i(\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{u}') \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.73)$$

$$(\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})(\mathbf{u}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})(\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) = (2(\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{u}')\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{u}') \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.74)$$

Define $\mathbf{u}'_{\parallel} = (\mathbf{u}' \cdot \mathbf{u})\mathbf{u}$ and $\mathbf{u}'_{\perp} = \mathbf{u}' - \mathbf{u}'_{\parallel}$. Then

$$\Pi_{\pm}(\mathbf{u}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})\Pi_{\pm} = \pm(\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{u}')\Pi_{\pm}, \quad (3.75)$$

$$\Pi_{\pm}(\mathbf{u}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})\Pi_{\mp} = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{u}'_{\perp} \pm i(\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{u}')) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} \Pi_{\mp}. \quad (3.76)$$

For comparison, define $\Pi'_\pm := \frac{1}{2}(1 \pm \mathbf{u}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})$. Their products are

$$\Pi_+ \Pi'_+ = \frac{1}{4}(1 + \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{u}') + \frac{1}{4}(\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{u}' + i\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{u}') \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.77)$$

$$\Pi_+ \Pi'_- = \frac{1}{4}(1 - \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{u}') + \frac{1}{4}(\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{u}' - i\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{u}') \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.78)$$

$$\Pi_- \Pi'_+ = \frac{1}{4}(1 - \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{u}') + \frac{1}{4}(-\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{u}' - i\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{u}') \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.79)$$

$$\Pi_- \Pi'_- = \frac{1}{4}(1 + \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{u}') + \frac{1}{4}(-\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{u}' + i\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{u}') \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.80)$$

3.7 Functions of paravectors

General projector rule. Let

$$\lambda_+, \lambda_- \in \mathbb{C}. \quad (3.81)$$

Suppose $\Pi_\pm^2 = \Pi_\pm$, $\Pi_+ + \Pi_- = 1$, $\Pi_+ \Pi_- = \Pi_- \Pi_+ = 0$, and

$$Z = \lambda_+ \Pi_+ + \lambda_- \Pi_-. \quad (3.82)$$

Then orthogonality gives

$$Z^n = \lambda_+^n \Pi_+ + \lambda_-^n \Pi_-. \quad (3.83)$$

Thus, for a convergent power series $f(w) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} c_n w^n$,

$$f(Z) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} c_n Z^n \quad (3.84)$$

$$= f(\lambda_+) \Pi_+ + f(\lambda_-) \Pi_-. \quad (3.85)$$

Functions of a unit vector. For $X = \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} = \Pi_+ - \Pi_-$, the eigenvalues are ± 1 . The general rule and $\Pi_\pm = \frac{1}{2}(1 \pm \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})$ give

$$f(\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) = f(1) \Pi_+ + f(-1) \Pi_- = \frac{1}{2}(f(1) + f(-1)) + \frac{1}{2}(f(1) - f(-1)) \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.86)$$

Consequently,

$$\sqrt{\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}} = \pm \Pi_+ \pm i \Pi_-, \quad (3.87)$$

$$\log(\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) = 2i\pi(n\Pi_+ + (\frac{1}{2} + m)\Pi_-), \quad (3.88)$$

$$(z + \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})^{-1} = \frac{z - \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}}{z^2 - 1}, \quad z^2 \neq 1, \quad (3.89)$$

$$\exp(\theta \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) = \cosh \theta + \sinh \theta \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.90)$$

$$\exp(i\theta \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.91)$$

For $0 < \|\mathbf{r}\| < 1$, take $\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{r}/\|\mathbf{r}\|$. Then

$$\frac{1 - \mathbf{r} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}}{1 + \mathbf{r} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}} = \exp(-2 \tanh^{-1}(\|\mathbf{r}\|)) \Pi_+ + \exp(2 \tanh^{-1}(\|\mathbf{r}\|)) \Pi_-. \quad (3.92)$$

Real paravectors. Let $X = a + \mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$ and $Y = b + \mathbf{B} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$, where $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$ and $\mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \in \mathbb{R}^3$. For $\mathbf{A} \neq 0$, put $\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{A}/\|\mathbf{A}\|$ and define

$$\lambda_\pm := a \pm \|\mathbf{A}\|. \quad (3.93)$$

Using $1 = \Pi_+ + \Pi_-$ and $\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} = \Pi_+ - \Pi_-$ gives

$$X = a(\Pi_+ + \Pi_-) + \|\mathbf{A}\|(\Pi_+ - \Pi_-) \quad (3.94)$$

$$= \lambda_+ \Pi_+ + \lambda_- \Pi_-. \quad (3.95)$$

The general rule therefore gives

$$f(X) = f(\lambda_+) \Pi_+ + f(\lambda_-) \Pi_-. \quad (3.96)$$

With nonzero eigenvalues where required and chosen function branches, this includes

$$X^n = \frac{1}{2}(\lambda_+^n + \lambda_-^n) + \frac{1}{2}(\lambda_+^n - \lambda_-^n) \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.97)$$

$$X^{-1} = \lambda_+^{-1} \Pi_+ + \lambda_-^{-1} \Pi_-, \quad (3.98)$$

$$\sqrt{X} = \pm \sqrt{\lambda_+} \Pi_+ \pm \sqrt{\lambda_-} \Pi_-, \quad (3.99)$$

$$\log X = \log(\lambda_+) \Pi_+ + \log(\lambda_-) \Pi_-, \quad (3.100)$$

$$\exp(X) = \exp(a) (\cosh \|\mathbf{A}\| + \sinh \|\mathbf{A}\| \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}), \quad (3.101)$$

$$\exp(i\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) = \cos \|\mathbf{A}\| + i \sin \|\mathbf{A}\| \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.102)$$

The formulas extend continuously to $\mathbf{A} = 0$.

For direct component formulas, if $X^2 = Y$, then

$$a^2 = \frac{1}{2} \left(b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - \mathbf{B}^2} \right), \quad \mathbf{A}^2 = b - a^2, \quad (3.103)$$

with signs and vector direction chosen consistently. Conversely, where $b^2 > \mathbf{B}^2$, $b > 0$, and $\mathbf{B} \neq 0$,

$$\log Y = \frac{1}{2} \log(b^2 - \mathbf{B}^2) + \tanh^{-1} \left(\frac{\|\mathbf{B}\|}{b} \right) \frac{\mathbf{B}}{\|\mathbf{B}\|} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.104)$$

Complex paravectors. For $Z = S + \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$, with $S \in \mathbb{C}$ and $\mathbf{V} \in \mathbb{C}^3$, let $z := \sqrt{\mathbf{V}^2} \in \mathbb{C}$ and define

$$\lambda_{\pm} := S \pm z. \quad (3.105)$$

When $z \neq 0$, define

$$\Pi_{\pm} := \frac{1}{2} \left(1 \pm \frac{\mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}}{z} \right). \quad (3.106)$$

Because $(\mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})^2 = \mathbf{V}^2 = z^2$,

$$\Pi_{\pm}^2 = \frac{1}{4} \left(1 \pm 2 \frac{\mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}}{z} + \frac{(\mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})^2}{z^2} \right) = \Pi_{\pm}, \quad (3.107)$$

$$\Pi_+ \Pi_- = \frac{1}{4} \left(1 - \frac{(\mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})^2}{z^2} \right) = 0. \quad (3.108)$$

Also, $1 = \Pi_+ + \Pi_-$ and $\mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} = z(\Pi_+ - \Pi_-)$, so

$$Z = S(\Pi_+ + \Pi_-) + z(\Pi_+ - \Pi_-) \quad (3.109)$$

$$= \lambda_+ \Pi_+ + \lambda_- \Pi_-. \quad (3.110)$$

The general rule gives

$$f(Z) = f(\lambda_+)\Pi_+ + f(\lambda_-)\Pi_- . \quad (3.111)$$

Choosing square-root branches gives

$$\sqrt{Z} = \sqrt{\lambda_+}\Pi_+ + \sqrt{\lambda_-}\Pi_- \quad (3.112)$$

$$= \frac{1}{2}(\sqrt{\lambda_+} + \sqrt{\lambda_-}) + \frac{\sqrt{\lambda_+} - \sqrt{\lambda_-}}{2z} \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (3.113)$$

and, when $\lambda_{\pm} \neq 0$, choosing logarithm branches gives

$$\log Z = \log(\lambda_+)\Pi_+ + \log(\lambda_-)\Pi_- \quad (3.114)$$

$$= \frac{1}{2}(\log(\lambda_+) + \log(\lambda_-)) + \frac{\log(\lambda_+) - \log(\lambda_-)}{2z} \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.115)$$

Also,

$$\exp(Z) = \exp(S) \left(\cosh z + \frac{\sinh z}{z} \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right), \quad (3.116)$$

$$\exp(Z^*) = \exp(Z)^*, \quad \exp(-Z) = \exp(Z)^{-1}. \quad (3.117)$$

At $z = 0$, these formulas are understood by analytic limits whenever the chosen function branch is analytic near S .

3.8 Differentiated fields

For products of fields,

$$\partial(ZZ') = (\partial Z)Z' + Z(\partial Z') + [\boldsymbol{\sigma}, Z] \cdot \partial_{\mathbf{r}} Z'. \quad (3.118)$$

Let $F = (a + bi) + (\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B}i) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$ depend on $(t, \mathbf{r})$. Then

$$\partial F = (\partial_t a + \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \mathbf{A}) + i(\partial_t b + \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \mathbf{B}) \quad (3.119)$$

$$+ (\partial_{\mathbf{r}} a + \partial_t \mathbf{A} - \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} \quad (3.120)$$

$$+ i(\partial_{\mathbf{r}} b + \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \mathbf{A} + \partial_t \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (3.121)$$

Multiplication by i rotates these four components: the real scalar becomes $-\partial_t b - \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \mathbf{B}$, the imaginary scalar becomes $\partial_t a + \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \mathbf{A}$, the real vector becomes the negative of the imaginary vector above, and the imaginary vector becomes the real vector.

4 Space-time kinematics

4.1 Intervals, velocity, and momentum

Represent a differential event by the real paravector

$$dX = dt + d\mathbf{r} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad dX^* = dt - d\mathbf{r} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (4.1)$$

The Minkowski interval is

$$ds^2 = \det(dX) = dX dX^* = dt^2 - d\mathbf{r}^2. \quad (4.2)$$

It is time-like, null, or space-like according as this expression is positive, zero, or negative. For a future-directed time-like interval, choose the positive scalar root

$$ds := \sqrt{\det(dX)}. \quad (4.3)$$

Thus the following kinematics explores the determinant of dX and its normalization by this scalar. For two intervals,

$$\det(dX + dX') - \det(dX) - \det(dX') = 2(dt dt' - d\mathbf{r} \cdot d\mathbf{r}'), \quad [dX, dX'] = 2i(d\mathbf{r} \times d\mathbf{r}') \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (4.4)$$

When $ds^2 \neq 0$,

$$dX^{-1} = \frac{\text{adj}(dX)}{\det(dX)} = \frac{dX^*}{ds^2}. \quad (4.5)$$

A null interval has $dt^2 = d\mathbf{r}^2$ and no inverse. Along a time-like worldline, s is proper time. Since $d\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{v} dt$,

$$ds^2 = (1 - \mathbf{v}^2) dt^2, \quad ds = \frac{dt}{\gamma}, \quad \gamma := \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 - \mathbf{v}^2}}. \quad (4.6)$$

Hence

$$\mathbf{v} = \frac{d\mathbf{r}}{dt}, \quad \gamma = \frac{dt}{ds}, \quad U := \frac{dX}{ds} = \gamma(1 + \mathbf{v} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}). \quad (4.7)$$

Using the scalar-scaling rule (3.42), its determinant is

$$\det(U) = \det\left(\frac{dX}{ds}\right) = \frac{\det(dX)}{ds^2} = 1. \quad (4.8)$$

Equivalently, $\det(U) = \gamma^2(1 - \mathbf{v}^2) = 1$, so

$$U^{-1} = \frac{\text{adj}(U)}{\det(U)} = U^*. \quad (4.9)$$

Proper time therefore obeys

$$\tau = \int ds = \int \sqrt{1 - \mathbf{v}^2} dt = \int \frac{dt}{\gamma}. \quad (4.10)$$

The four-momentum is the paravector

$$mU = m\gamma + m\gamma\mathbf{v} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} = E + \mathbf{P} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (4.11)$$

Its scalar and vector components define

$$E := m\gamma, \quad \mathbf{P} := m\gamma\mathbf{v}. \quad (4.12)$$

Taking its determinant gives the mass-shell relation

$$\det(mU) = m^2 \det(U) = m^2 = \det(E + \mathbf{P} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) = E^2 - \mathbf{P}^2, \quad (4.13)$$

or $E^2 = \mathbf{P}^2 + m^2$; for $m = 0$, $E^2 = \mathbf{P}^2$.

For coordinate acceleration $\mathbf{a} = d\mathbf{v}/dt$,

$$\frac{d\gamma}{dt} = \gamma^3 \mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{a}, \quad \frac{d}{ds} = \gamma \frac{d}{dt}, \quad (4.14)$$

so

$$\frac{dU}{ds} = \gamma^4(\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{a}) + (\gamma^4(\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{a})\mathbf{v} + \gamma^2\mathbf{a}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (4.15)$$

Differentiating $U^*U = 1$ gives

$$\frac{dU^*}{ds}U + U^*\frac{dU}{ds} = 0, \quad \text{sc}(U^* dU/ds) = 0. \quad (4.16)$$

If $A = dU/ds$, then

$$\det(A) = -\gamma^4(\mathbf{a}^2 + \gamma^2(\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{a})^2). \quad (4.17)$$

For $\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{v}/\|\mathbf{v}\|$, define $\mathbf{a}_{\parallel} = (\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{u})\mathbf{u}$ and $\mathbf{a}_{\perp} = \mathbf{a} - \mathbf{a}_{\parallel}$. Then

$$\det(A) = -\gamma^4(\mathbf{a}_{\perp}^2 + \gamma^2\mathbf{a}_{\parallel}^2). \quad (4.18)$$

The product U^*A has zero scalar part, real vector $\gamma^3\mathbf{a}$, and imaginary vector $-\gamma^3\mathbf{v} \times \mathbf{a}$; while UA has real scalar $2\gamma^5\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{a}$, real vector $\gamma^3\mathbf{a} + 2\gamma^5(\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{a})\mathbf{v}$, and imaginary vector $\gamma^3\mathbf{v} \times \mathbf{a}$.

4.2 Free-particle action

The free-particle action and Lagrangian are

$$\int L dt = -m \int ds, \quad L = -m\sqrt{1 - \mathbf{v}^2} = -\frac{m}{\gamma}. \quad (4.19)$$

For a general Lagrangian $L(t, \mathbf{r}, \mathbf{v})$,

$$\frac{d}{dt}\partial_{\mathbf{v}}L = \partial_{\mathbf{r}}L, \quad H = \mathbf{v} \cdot \partial_{\mathbf{v}}L - L, \quad \frac{dH}{dt} = -\partial_t L. \quad (4.20)$$

Thus spatial translation invariance conserves canonical momentum and time translation invariance conserves the Hamiltonian. For the free-particle Lagrangian,

$$\partial_{\mathbf{v}}L = m\gamma\mathbf{v}, \quad (4.21)$$

$$H = m\gamma\mathbf{v}^2 + \frac{m}{\gamma} = m\gamma(\mathbf{v}^2 + \gamma^{-2}) = m\gamma. \quad (4.22)$$

At low velocity, the binomial expansions are

$$\sqrt{1 - \mathbf{v}^2} = 1 - \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{v}^2 + O(v^4), \quad \gamma = 1 + \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{v}^2 + O(v^4). \quad (4.23)$$

Multiplying the first expansion by $-m$ gives

$$L = -m\sqrt{1 - \mathbf{v}^2} = -m + \frac{1}{2}m\mathbf{v}^2 + O(v^4), \quad (4.24)$$

while the second gives

$$H = m\gamma = m + \frac{1}{2}m\mathbf{v}^2 + O(v^4). \quad (4.25)$$

Thus, apart from the constant rest-energy term, both recover the nonrelativistic kinetic energy $\frac{1}{2}m\mathbf{v}^2$.

5 Electromagnetism

5.1 Field equation and potentials

Introduce the paravector differential operator, electromagnetic field, and source

$$\partial = \partial_t + \boldsymbol{\sigma} \cdot \partial_{\mathbf{r}}, \quad F = (\mathbf{E} + \mathbf{B}\mathbf{i}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad D = \rho + \mathbf{J} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (5.1)$$

All four Maxwell equations are the single equation

$$\partial F = D^* = \rho - \mathbf{J} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (5.2)$$

Sigma conjugation gives the equivalent equation

$$\partial^* F^* = D. \quad (5.3)$$

Expanding the left side by component gives

$$\partial F = \underbrace{\partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \mathbf{E}}_{\text{real scalar}} + \underbrace{\mathbf{i} \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \mathbf{B}}_{\text{imaginary scalar}} \quad (5.4)$$

$$+ \underbrace{(\partial_t \mathbf{E} - \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}}_{\text{real vector}} \quad (5.5)$$

$$+ \underbrace{\mathbf{i}(\partial_t \mathbf{B} + \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \mathbf{E}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}}_{\text{imaginary vector}}. \quad (5.6)$$

Equating these four components with those of $\rho - \mathbf{J} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$ gives, respectively,

$$\text{real scalar: } \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \mathbf{E} = \rho, \quad (5.7)$$

$$\text{imaginary scalar: } \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \mathbf{B} = 0, \quad (5.8)$$

$$\text{real vector: } \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \mathbf{B} = \mathbf{J} + \partial_t \mathbf{E}, \quad (5.9)$$

$$\text{imaginary vector: } \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \mathbf{E} = -\partial_t \mathbf{B}. \quad (5.10)$$

The conjugate operator products give

$$\partial \partial^* = \partial^* \partial = \partial_t^2 - \partial_{\mathbf{r}}^2 =: \square, \quad (5.11)$$

whereas

$$\partial^2 = \partial_t^2 + \partial_{\mathbf{r}}^2 + 2\partial_t \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} \neq \square. \quad (5.12)$$

Applying ∂^* to (5.2) gives

$$\square F = \partial^* D^* \quad (5.13)$$

$$= (\partial_t \rho + \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \mathbf{J}) + (-\partial_t \mathbf{J} - \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \rho + \mathbf{i} \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \mathbf{J}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (5.14)$$

The real-scalar component is charge conservation, and the real- and imaginary-vector components are the electric and magnetic wave equations:

$$\text{real scalar: } \partial_t \rho + \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \mathbf{J} = 0, \quad (5.15)$$

$$\text{real vector: } \square \mathbf{E} = -\partial_t \mathbf{J} - \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \rho, \quad (5.16)$$

$$\text{imaginary vector: } \square \mathbf{B} = \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \mathbf{J}. \quad (5.17)$$

In vacuum, $\rho = 0$ and $\mathbf{J} = 0$, so

$$\square \mathbf{E} = 0, \quad \square \mathbf{B} = 0. \quad (5.18)$$

For the potential $\Phi = V + \mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$,

$$\partial \Phi = \underbrace{\partial_t V + \partial_r \cdot \mathbf{A}}_{\text{real scalar}} + \underbrace{(\partial_t \mathbf{A} + \partial_r V) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}}_{\text{real vector}} \quad (5.19)$$

$$+ \underbrace{i(\partial_r \times \mathbf{A}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}}_{\text{imaginary vector}}. \quad (5.20)$$

Define the scalar component

$$S := \text{sc}(\partial \Phi) = \partial_t V + \partial_r \cdot \mathbf{A}. \quad (5.21)$$

Then $\partial \Phi = S + F^*$: its real-vector and imaginary-vector components give

$$\mathbf{E} = -\partial_t \mathbf{A} - \partial_r V, \quad \mathbf{B} = \partial_r \times \mathbf{A}. \quad (5.22)$$

Also, $F = \partial^* \Phi^* - S$, so

$$\partial F = \partial \partial^* \Phi^* - \partial S = \square \Phi^* - \partial S \quad (5.23)$$

$$= (\square V - \partial_t S) - (\square \mathbf{A} + \partial_r S) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (5.24)$$

Comparing its real-scalar and real-vector components with $\partial F = \rho - \mathbf{J} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$ gives

$$\rho = \square V - \partial_t S, \quad \mathbf{J} = \square \mathbf{A} + \partial_r S. \quad (5.25)$$

For a scalar field λ , the gauge transformation is

$$\Phi' = \Phi + \partial^* \lambda, \quad (5.26)$$

$$\partial \Phi' = \partial \Phi + \partial \partial^* \lambda = \partial \Phi + \square \lambda. \quad (5.27)$$

Because $\square \lambda$ is scalar, only the scalar component changes:

$$S' = S + \square \lambda, \quad \text{vec}(\partial \Phi') = \text{vec}(\partial \Phi). \quad (5.28)$$

Thus F is unchanged. In the Lorenz gauge $S = 0$, equation (5.25) reduces to

$$\rho = \square V, \quad \mathbf{J} = \square \mathbf{A}. \quad (5.29)$$

5.2 Field invariants

Electric and magnetic fields mix under Lorentz transformations, so their individual magnitudes depend on the observer. Two combinations remain the same for every inertial observer and therefore classify the electromagnetic field itself.

For

$$F = (\mathbf{E} + \mathbf{B}i) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (5.30)$$

the scalar part vanishes, and therefore $\text{adj}(F) = -F$. Hence

$$\det(F) = -F^2 \quad (5.31)$$

$$= -(\mathbf{E} + \mathbf{B}i) \cdot (\mathbf{E} + \mathbf{B}i) \quad (5.32)$$

$$= -\mathbf{E}^2 + \mathbf{B}^2 - 2i\mathbf{E} \cdot \mathbf{B}. \quad (5.33)$$

For any invertible real or complex paravector T , let

$$F' = T F T^{-1}. \quad (5.34)$$

The general similarity identity (3.15) gives

$$\det(F') = \det(T F T^{-1}) = \det(F). \quad (5.35)$$

Rotations and boosts are the physical special cases

$$F' = R F R^{-1} = R F R^H, \quad F' = L F L^{-1} = L F L^*, \quad (5.36)$$

because $R^{-1} = R^H$ and $L^{-1} = L^*$. Hence every inertial observer agrees on

$$a := \mathbf{E}^2 - \mathbf{B}^2 = -\operatorname{re}(\det(F)), \quad (5.37)$$

$$b := \mathbf{E} \cdot \mathbf{B} = -\frac{1}{2} \operatorname{im}(\det(F)). \quad (5.38)$$

For nonzero fields, these invariants give the standard classification:

$$b = 0, a > 0 : \quad \text{electric-like; some frame has } \mathbf{B}' = 0, \quad (5.39)$$

$$b = 0, a < 0 : \quad \text{magnetic-like; some frame has } \mathbf{E}' = 0, \quad (5.40)$$

$$a = b = 0 : \quad \text{null or radiation-like; } \mathbf{E} \perp \mathbf{B} \text{ and } \|\mathbf{E}\| = \|\mathbf{B}\|, \quad (5.41)$$

$$b \neq 0 : \quad \text{no frame can eliminate either field.} \quad (5.42)$$

Thus the invariants reveal physical properties that cannot be inferred from one observer's values of $\mathbf{E}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ alone. Unlike the energy density and flux below, they do not change with the observer.

5.3 Lorentz force from the field and action

The Lorentz proper-force equation is

$$m \frac{dU}{ds} = q \operatorname{re}(F U) = \frac{q}{2} (F U + U F^H). \quad (5.43)$$

The Hermitian extraction removes the imaginary magnetic-dual components. The remaining scalar and vector components are, respectively,

$$\frac{d(m\gamma)}{dt} = q \mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{E}, \quad \frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} = q(\mathbf{E} + \mathbf{v} \times \mathbf{B}). \quad (5.44)$$

The same result follows from the potential through the interacting-particle action

$$\int L dt = -m \int ds - q \int \operatorname{sc}(\Phi^* U) ds \quad (5.45)$$

$$= \int \left(-\frac{m}{\gamma} - q \operatorname{sc}(\Phi^* U / \gamma) \right) dt \quad (5.46)$$

$$= \int \left(-\frac{m}{\gamma} - q \operatorname{sc}((V - \mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})(1 + \mathbf{v} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})) \right) dt \quad (5.47)$$

$$= \int \left(-\frac{m}{\gamma} - qV + q \mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{A} \right) dt. \quad (5.48)$$

Thus

$$L = -\frac{m}{\gamma} - q(V - \mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{A}), \quad \partial_{\mathbf{v}} L = m\gamma \mathbf{v} + q\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{P} + q\mathbf{A}. \quad (5.49)$$

The Euler–Lagrange terms are

$$\frac{d}{dt} \partial_{\mathbf{v}} L = \frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} + q\partial_t \mathbf{A} + q(\mathbf{v} \cdot \partial_{\mathbf{r}}) \mathbf{A}, \quad (5.50)$$

$$\partial_{\mathbf{r}} L = -q\partial_{\mathbf{r}} V + q\partial_{\mathbf{r}}(\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{A}). \quad (5.51)$$

Using $(\mathbf{v} \cdot \partial_{\mathbf{r}}) \mathbf{A} = \partial_{\mathbf{r}}(\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{A}) - \mathbf{v} \times (\partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \mathbf{A})$ gives

$$\frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} = -q\partial_{\mathbf{r}} V - q\partial_t \mathbf{A} + q(\partial_{\mathbf{r}}(\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{A}) - (\mathbf{v} \cdot \partial_{\mathbf{r}}) \mathbf{A}) \quad (5.52)$$

$$= q(-\partial_{\mathbf{r}} V - \partial_t \mathbf{A} + \mathbf{v} \times (\partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \mathbf{A})) \quad (5.53)$$

$$= q(\mathbf{E} + \mathbf{v} \times \mathbf{B}). \quad (5.54)$$

The Hamiltonian follows with the gauge-dependent terms cancelling:

$$H = \mathbf{v} \cdot \partial_{\mathbf{v}} L - L \quad (5.55)$$

$$= m\gamma \mathbf{v}^2 + q\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{A} + \frac{m}{\gamma} + qV - q\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{A} \quad (5.56)$$

$$= m\gamma(\mathbf{v}^2 + \gamma^{-2}) + qV = m\gamma + qV. \quad (5.57)$$

Finally, $dH/dt = -\partial_t L$ gives

$$\frac{d(m\gamma)}{dt} + q\partial_t V + q\mathbf{v} \cdot \partial_{\mathbf{r}} V = q\partial_t V - q\mathbf{v} \cdot \partial_t \mathbf{A}, \quad (5.58)$$

$$\frac{d(m\gamma)}{dt} = q\mathbf{v} \cdot (-\partial_{\mathbf{r}} V - \partial_t \mathbf{A}) = q\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{E}. \quad (5.59)$$

To see equation (5.43) componentwise, expand

$$\frac{FU}{\gamma} = \mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{E} + i\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{B} + (\mathbf{E} + \mathbf{v} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} + i(\mathbf{B} + \mathbf{E} \times \mathbf{v}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (5.60)$$

Taking the real paravector part removes the two imaginary components.

5.4 Energy balance

Since

$$F = (\mathbf{E} + \mathbf{B}i) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad F^H = (\mathbf{E} - \mathbf{B}i) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (5.61)$$

their ordered product is

$$FF^H = \mathbf{E}^2 + \mathbf{B}^2 + 2(\mathbf{E} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (5.62)$$

Therefore the standard electromagnetic energy density u and Poynting vector $\mathbf{S}$ are the scalar and vector coefficients of $\frac{1}{2}FF^H$:

$$u := \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{E}^2 + \mathbf{B}^2) = \frac{1}{2} \text{sc}(FF^H), \quad (5.63)$$

$$\mathbf{S} := \mathbf{E} \times \mathbf{B} = \frac{1}{2} \text{vec}(FF^H). \quad (5.64)$$

These quantities describe energy measured in the chosen frame; they are not the two Lorentz invariants contained in F^2 . The product $\frac{1}{2}FF^H$ packages energy density and energy flux into a paravector, but is not by itself the full electromagnetic stress-energy tensor. This product order gives the conventional sign of the Poynting vector directly. For comparison, reversing the order preserves the scalar coefficient and changes the sign of the vector coefficient:

$$\text{sc}(F^H F) = \text{sc}(FF^H), \quad \text{vec}(F^H F) = -\text{vec}(FF^H). \quad (5.65)$$

Starting only from the paravector field equation $\partial F = D^*$, its real-vector and imaginary-vector components give

$$\partial_t \mathbf{E} = \partial_r \times \mathbf{B} - \mathbf{J}, \quad \partial_t \mathbf{B} = -\partial_r \times \mathbf{E}. \quad (5.66)$$

Taking their dot products with $\mathbf{E}$ and $\mathbf{B}$, respectively, yields

$$\partial_t u = \mathbf{E} \cdot \partial_t \mathbf{E} + \mathbf{B} \cdot \partial_t \mathbf{B} \quad (5.67)$$

$$= \mathbf{E} \cdot (\partial_r \times \mathbf{B}) - \mathbf{E} \cdot \mathbf{J} - \mathbf{B} \cdot (\partial_r \times \mathbf{E}) \quad (5.68)$$

$$= -\partial_r \cdot \mathbf{S} - \mathbf{J} \cdot \mathbf{E}, \quad (5.69)$$

where $\partial_r \cdot (\mathbf{E} \times \mathbf{B}) = \mathbf{B} \cdot (\partial_r \times \mathbf{E}) - \mathbf{E} \cdot (\partial_r \times \mathbf{B})$. Substitution into $\partial_t u$ therefore derives Poynting's theorem, the local electromagnetic energy-balance law:

$$\partial_t u + \partial_r \cdot \mathbf{S} = -\mathbf{J} \cdot \mathbf{E}. \quad (5.70)$$

Here $\mathbf{J} \cdot \mathbf{E}$ is the power density transferred from the field to matter; the minus sign is the corresponding loss of field energy. Equivalently, in paravector coefficients,

$$\frac{1}{2} \partial_t \text{sc}(FF^H) + \frac{1}{2} \partial_r \cdot \text{vec}(FF^H) = -\mathbf{J} \cdot \mathbf{E}. \quad (5.71)$$

6 Relativistic wave equations

6.1 Paravector inner products and expectations

A paravector amplitude ψ maps to the complex matrix $\mathbf{M}_\psi = \text{mat}(\psi)$. Therefore $\text{mat}(\psi^H \psi) = \mathbf{M}_\psi^H \mathbf{M}_\psi$, which is generally a Hermitian matrix rather than a scalar.

For paravector amplitudes ψ, ψ' and a paravector Z , use the Hilbert–Schmidt pairing to define

$$\langle \psi' | \psi \rangle := \text{sc}(\psi'^H \psi) = \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\mathbf{M}_{\psi'}^H \mathbf{M}_\psi), \quad (6.1)$$

$$\langle \psi' | Z | \psi \rangle := \text{sc}(\psi'^H Z \psi) = \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\mathbf{M}_{\psi'}^H \text{mat}(Z) \mathbf{M}_\psi). \quad (6.2)$$

The first is the $Z = 1$ case of the second, and $\langle \psi | \psi \rangle = \|\psi\|^2$. Thus normalization is $\text{sc}(\psi^H \psi) = 1$, not $\psi^H \psi = 1$. For an observable $Z^H = Z$ acting from the left,

$$\langle Z \rangle_\psi := \frac{\langle \psi | Z | \psi \rangle}{\langle \psi | \psi \rangle} = \frac{\text{sc}(\psi^H Z \psi)}{\text{sc}(\psi^H \psi)}. \quad (6.3)$$

For normalized ψ , this reduces to $\langle Z \rangle_\psi = \langle \psi | Z | \psi \rangle$.

For a paravector T with $\psi' = T\psi$,

$$\langle Z \rangle_{\psi'} = \frac{\text{sc}(\psi^H T^H Z T \psi)}{\text{sc}(\psi^H T^H T \psi)}. \quad (6.4)$$

For a unitary rotation the denominator is unchanged. A finite boost is not unitary, so this positive equal-time norm is not itself Lorentz invariant; the covariant Dirac normalization instead comes from the conserved Dirac current on a spacelike hypersurface.

6.2 Physical spinors and minimal ideals

A physical two-component Pauli spinor occupies a minimal left ideal. For any unit direction $\mathbf{u}$, represent the algebra projectors from Section 3.6 by the matrices

$$\Pi_{\pm}(\mathbf{u}) := \text{mat}\left(\frac{1}{2}(1 \pm \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})\right) = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{I}_2 \pm \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}). \quad (6.5)$$

They inherit

$$\Pi_{\pm}(\mathbf{u})^2 = \Pi_{\pm}(\mathbf{u}), \quad \Pi_{+}(\mathbf{u})\Pi_{-}(\mathbf{u}) = 0, \quad \Pi_{+}(\mathbf{u}) + \Pi_{-}(\mathbf{u}) = \mathbf{I}_2, \quad (6.6)$$

$$\Pi_{\pm}(\mathbf{u})^H = \Pi_{\pm}(\mathbf{u}), \quad \Pi_{\pm}(\mathbf{u})^* = \Pi_{\mp}(\mathbf{u}), \quad (\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})\Pi_{\pm}(\mathbf{u}) = \pm\Pi_{\pm}(\mathbf{u}), \quad (6.7)$$

and hence $\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} = \Pi_{+}(\mathbf{u}) - \Pi_{-}(\mathbf{u})$.

Choose a fixed reference direction $\mathbf{u}_0$, set $\Pi_{+} := \frac{1}{2}(1 + \mathbf{u}_0 \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})$, and project on the right:

$$\psi' := \psi\Pi_{+}, \quad \mathbf{M}_{\psi'} := \text{mat}(\psi') = \mathbf{M}_{\psi}\Pi_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0). \quad (6.8)$$

Let $\mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0)$ be a normalized positive eigenvector,

$$(\mathbf{u}_0 \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})\mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0) = \mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0), \quad \mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0)^H \mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0) = 1. \quad (6.9)$$

A convenient phase choice, valid for $u_{0,3} \neq -1$, is

$$\mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0) = \frac{\{1 + u_{0,3}, u_{0,1} + iu_{0,2}\}^T}{\sqrt{2(1 + u_{0,3})}}; \quad \mathbf{e}_{+}(-\mathbf{e}_3) = \{0, 1\}^T. \quad (6.10)$$

Define the conventional column spinor $\chi \in \mathbb{C}^2$ by

$$\Pi_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0) = \mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0)\mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0)^H, \quad \chi := \mathbf{M}_{\psi}\mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0). \quad (6.11)$$

The algebra, rank-one matrix, and column forms of the state are related by

$$\chi = \mathbf{M}_{\psi'}\mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0), \quad \mathbf{M}_{\psi'} = \chi\mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0)^H. \quad (6.12)$$

Thus ψ' and χ contain the same two complex components. $\mathbf{M}_{\psi'}$ has rank one and has χ as its first column precisely when the basis begins with $\mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0)$. Conversely, $\chi\mathbf{e}_{+}(\mathbf{u}_0)^H$ uniquely determines ψ' . The column χ is a 2×1 vector, so $\chi^H\chi$ is scalar, and

$$\chi^H\chi = \text{tr}(\mathbf{M}_{\psi'}^H\mathbf{M}_{\psi'}) = 2\text{sc}(\psi'^H\psi'), \quad (6.13)$$

$$\chi^H \text{mat}(Z)\chi = \text{tr}(\mathbf{M}_{\psi'}^H \text{mat}(Z)\mathbf{M}_{\psi'}) = 2\text{sc}(\psi'^H Z \psi'). \quad (6.14)$$

The factor two cancels in normalized expectations. An unrestricted paravector matrix contains two Pauli-spinor columns; right projection by Π_{+} , or by Π_{+} in matrix form, selects one. Applied to both components of the Dirac block below, it selects one conventional four-component Dirac column.

6.3 Klein–Gordon equation

With $E = i\partial_t$ and $\mathbf{P} = -i\partial_r$, the mass-shell relation becomes the scalar wave equation

$$(\square + m^2)\Psi = 0. \quad (6.15)$$

Writing $\Omega = \sqrt{m^2 - \partial_{\mathbf{r}}^2}$ gives the frequency decomposition

$$(\partial_t \pm i\Omega)\Psi_{\pm} = 0, \quad \Psi = \Psi_+ + \Psi_-. \quad (6.16)$$

The square-root operator is understood spectrally: on a plane wave with wave vector $\mathbf{k}$, Ω multiplies by $\sqrt{m^2 + \mathbf{k}^2}$.

Minimal electromagnetic coupling replaces the operators by

$$E = i\partial_t - qV, \quad \mathbf{P} = -i\partial_{\mathbf{r}} - q\mathbf{A}, \quad (6.17)$$

so that $(-E^2 + \mathbf{P}^2 + m^2)\Psi = 0$.

6.4 Dirac equation in block form

For a paravector Z , define

$$\mathbf{W}(Z) := \begin{pmatrix} 0 & Z \\ \text{adj}(Z) & 0 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (6.18)$$

It satisfies

$$\mathbf{W}(Z)^2 = \text{diag}(Z \text{adj}(Z), \text{adj}(Z) Z), \quad \mathbf{W}(Z)^* = \mathbf{W}(Z^*), \quad \mathbf{W}(Z)^H = \mathbf{W}(Z^H). \quad (6.19)$$

Since $\mathbf{W}(i\partial)^2 = -\square \mathbf{I}$, the first-order equation

$$(\mathbf{W}(i\partial) - m\mathbf{I})\Psi = 0 \quad (6.20)$$

squares to the Klein–Gordon equation. For $\Psi = \{\Psi_1, \Psi_2\}^T$ it reads

$$i\partial\Psi_2 - m\Psi_1 = 0, \quad i\partial^*\Psi_1 - m\Psi_2 = 0. \quad (6.21)$$

Conversely, for $m \neq 0$, any scalar solution Ψ' of $(\square + m^2)\Psi' = 0$ gives a Dirac solution

$$\Psi = \left\{ \Psi', \frac{i}{m} \partial^* \Psi' \right\}^T. \quad (6.22)$$

Indeed, the second component equation holds by definition, and the first reduces to $-(\square + m^2)\Psi'/m = 0$. The characteristic equation is $(s + m)^2 + \square = 0$, hence $s = -m \pm i\sqrt{\square}$. With a potential, the gauge-covariant form is

$$(\mathbf{W}(i\partial - q\Phi^*) - m\mathbf{I})\Psi = 0. \quad (6.23)$$

It is invariant under $\Phi' = \Phi + \partial^*\lambda$ and $\Psi = \exp(iq\lambda)\Psi'$.

6.5 Schrödinger–Pauli limit

Removing the rest-energy oscillation and expanding at low momentum gives the Pauli equation

$$i\partial_t \Psi = \left(\frac{(-i\partial_{\mathbf{r}} - q\mathbf{A})^2}{2m} + qV - \frac{q}{2m} \mathbf{B} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right) \Psi. \quad (6.24)$$

Using these projectors, $\Psi = \Psi_+ + \Psi_-$ with $\Psi_{\pm} = \Pi_{\pm}(\mathbf{u})\Psi$. For a uniform static magnetic field, $\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{B}/\|\mathbf{B}\|$, the sectors decouple:

$$i\partial_t \Psi_{\pm} = \left(\frac{\mathbf{P}^2 \mp q\|\mathbf{B}\|}{2m} + qV \right) \Psi_{\pm}. \quad (6.25)$$

For a varying field direction the sectors are coupled. With H denoting the Pauli Hamiltonian, direct differentiation gives

$$\mathrm{i}\partial_t \Psi_{\pm} = \mathrm{i}(\partial_t \Pi_{\pm}) \Psi + \Pi_{\pm} H \Psi \quad (6.26)$$

$$= H \Psi_{\pm} + (\mathrm{i}\partial_t \Pi_{\pm} + [\Pi_{\pm}, H]) \Psi. \quad (6.27)$$

Because the field term commutes with its own instantaneous projectors, this is

$$\mathrm{i}\partial_t \Psi_{\pm} = H \Psi_{\pm} + S_{\pm}, \quad S_{\pm} = \left(\mathrm{i}\partial_t \Pi_{\pm} + \frac{[\mathbf{P}^2, \Pi_{\pm}]}{2m} \right) \Psi. \quad (6.28)$$

6.6 Interacting operators and factorization

The covariant energy and momentum operators do not commute. Direct application to a test wavefunction gives

$$[E, P_m] = \mathrm{i}qE_m, \quad [P_m, P_n] = \mathrm{i}q(\partial_m A_n - \partial_n A_m), \quad \mathbf{P} \times \mathbf{P} = \mathrm{i}q\mathbf{B}. \quad (6.29)$$

Therefore

$$(E + \boldsymbol{\sigma} \cdot \mathbf{P})(E - \boldsymbol{\sigma} \cdot \mathbf{P}) = E^2 - \mathbf{P}^2 - \mathrm{i}qF, \quad (6.30)$$

$$(E - \boldsymbol{\sigma} \cdot \mathbf{P})(E + \boldsymbol{\sigma} \cdot \mathbf{P}) = E^2 - \mathbf{P}^2 - \mathrm{i}qF^*, \quad (6.31)$$

$$E + \boldsymbol{\sigma} \cdot \mathbf{P} = \mathrm{i}\partial^* - q\Phi, \quad (6.32)$$

$$E - \boldsymbol{\sigma} \cdot \mathbf{P} = \mathrm{i}\partial - q\Phi^*. \quad (6.33)$$

Expanding the minimally coupled Klein–Gordon operator gives the fully explicit result

$$(\square + \mathrm{i}qS - q^2 \det(\Phi) + m^2 + 2\mathrm{i}q(V\partial_t + \mathbf{A} \cdot \partial_{\mathbf{r}})) \Psi = 0. \quad (6.34)$$

The two orderings satisfy

$$0 = ((\partial + \mathrm{i}q\Phi^*)(\partial^* + \mathrm{i}q\Phi) + m^2) \Psi_1 = (-E^2 + \mathbf{P}^2 + m^2 + \mathrm{i}qF^*) \Psi_1, \quad (6.35)$$

$$0 = ((\partial^* + \mathrm{i}q\Phi)(\partial + \mathrm{i}q\Phi^*) + m^2) \Psi_2 = (-E^2 + \mathbf{P}^2 + m^2 + \mathrm{i}qF) \Psi_2. \quad (6.36)$$

These follow by multiplying the Dirac operator by its mass conjugate. In detail, if $\mathbf{D} = \mathbf{W}(\mathrm{i}\partial - q\Phi^*) - m\mathbf{I}$ and $\mathbf{D}' = \mathbf{W}(\mathrm{i}\partial - q\Phi^*) + m\mathbf{I}$, then

$$\mathbf{D}'\mathbf{D} = -\text{diag}((\partial + \mathrm{i}q\Phi^*)(\partial^* + \mathrm{i}q\Phi) + m^2, (\partial^* + \mathrm{i}q\Phi)(\partial + \mathrm{i}q\Phi^*) + m^2). \quad (6.37)$$

For a paravector wavefunction $\psi = \psi_s + \boldsymbol{\psi}_v \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$,

$$\partial\psi = (\partial_t\psi_s + \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \boldsymbol{\psi}_v) + (\partial_t\boldsymbol{\psi}_v + \partial_{\mathbf{r}}\psi_s + \mathrm{i}\partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \boldsymbol{\psi}_v) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (6.38)$$

$$\partial^*\psi = (\partial_t\psi_s - \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \cdot \boldsymbol{\psi}_v) + (\partial_t\boldsymbol{\psi}_v - \partial_{\mathbf{r}}\psi_s - \mathrm{i}\partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \boldsymbol{\psi}_v) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (6.39)$$

$$\Phi\psi = (V\psi_s + \mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\psi}_v) + (V\boldsymbol{\psi}_v + \psi_s\mathbf{A} + \mathrm{i}\mathbf{A} \times \boldsymbol{\psi}_v) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (6.40)$$

$$\Phi^*\psi = (V\psi_s - \mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\psi}_v) + (V\boldsymbol{\psi}_v - \psi_s\mathbf{A} - \mathrm{i}\mathbf{A} \times \boldsymbol{\psi}_v) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (6.41)$$

Writing $F = \mathbf{F} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$,

$$\text{sc}(\mathrm{i}qF\psi) = \mathrm{i}q\mathbf{F} \cdot \boldsymbol{\psi}_v, \quad \text{vec}(\mathrm{i}qF\psi) = \mathrm{i}q\psi_s\mathbf{F} - q\mathbf{F} \times \boldsymbol{\psi}_v, \quad (6.42)$$

$$\text{sc}(\mathrm{i}qF^*\psi) = -\mathrm{i}q\mathbf{F}^* \cdot \boldsymbol{\psi}_v, \quad \text{vec}(\mathrm{i}qF^*\psi) = -\mathrm{i}q\psi_s\mathbf{F}^* + q\mathbf{F}^* \times \boldsymbol{\psi}_v. \quad (6.43)$$

6.7 Low-energy derivation

For spin zero, write $\Psi' = \exp(-imt)\Psi$. The exact equation becomes

$$(-E^2 - 2mE + \mathbf{P}^2)\Psi = 0, \quad E = \frac{\mathbf{P}^2 - E^2}{2m} = \frac{\mathbf{P}^2}{2m} - \frac{\mathbf{P}^4}{8m^3} + \dots \quad (6.44)$$

The leading term is the Schrödinger equation

$$i\partial_t \Psi = \left(\frac{(-i\partial_{\mathbf{r}} - q\mathbf{A})^2}{2m} + qV \right) \Psi. \quad (6.45)$$

For spin one-half, the two rest-mass-stripped Dirac equations are

$$(E + m - \mathbf{P} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})\Psi_2 - m\Psi_1 = 0, \quad (6.46)$$

$$(E + m + \mathbf{P} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})\Psi_1 - m\Psi_2 = 0. \quad (6.47)$$

Eliminating Ψ_1 gives

$$(E^2 + 2mE - \mathbf{P}^2 + q\mathbf{B} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} - iq\mathbf{E} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})\Psi_2 = 0, \quad (6.48)$$

and iteration yields $E = (\mathbf{P}^2 - q\mathbf{B} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})/(2m) + O(m^{-2})$, which is equation (6.24).

6.8 Spin, ladder operators, and energy sectors

The left measurement projection along $\mathbf{u}$ is distinct from the fixed right ideal projection along $\mathbf{u}_0$ defined above. For the ideal matrix $\mathbf{M}_{\psi'}$ and its nonzero column $\boldsymbol{\chi}$, define

$$\mathbf{M}_{\psi', \pm} := \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{\pm}(\mathbf{u})\mathbf{M}_{\psi'}, \quad \boldsymbol{\chi}_{\pm} := \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{\pm}(\mathbf{u})\boldsymbol{\chi}. \quad (6.49)$$

The components are orthogonal and complete:

$$\boldsymbol{\chi} = \boldsymbol{\chi}_+ + \boldsymbol{\chi}_-, \quad \boldsymbol{\chi}_+^H \boldsymbol{\chi}_- = 0, \quad \boldsymbol{\chi}_-^H \boldsymbol{\chi}_+ = 0. \quad (6.50)$$

For a normalized state, define its real Bloch vector by

$$s_n := \frac{\boldsymbol{\chi}^H \boldsymbol{\sigma}_n \boldsymbol{\chi}}{\boldsymbol{\chi}^H \boldsymbol{\chi}}, \quad \mathbf{s} := \{s_1, s_2, s_3\}, \quad \|\mathbf{s}\|^2 = 1. \quad (6.51)$$

The probabilities for spin along and against $\mathbf{u}$ are

$$p_{\pm}(\mathbf{u}) := \frac{\boldsymbol{\chi}_{\pm}^H \boldsymbol{\chi}_{\pm}}{\boldsymbol{\chi}^H \boldsymbol{\chi}} = \frac{\boldsymbol{\chi}^H \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{\pm}(\mathbf{u}) \boldsymbol{\chi}}{\boldsymbol{\chi}^H \boldsymbol{\chi}} = \frac{1}{2}(1 \pm \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{s}). \quad (6.52)$$

For a state aligned with $\mathbf{u}$ and $\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{u}' = \cos \theta$, the measurement probabilities along $\mathbf{u}'$ are

$$p_+(\mathbf{u}') = \frac{1}{2}(1 + \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{u}') = \cos^2(\theta/2), \quad p_-(\mathbf{u}') = \frac{1}{2}(1 - \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{u}') = \sin^2(\theta/2). \quad (6.53)$$

If $\mathbf{u}'$ is obtained by rotating $\mathbf{u}$ through ϕ about $\mathbf{n}$, then

$$\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{u}' = (\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{u})^2 + (1 - (\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{u})^2) \cos \phi. \quad (6.54)$$

Thus $\theta = \phi$ when $\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0$.

For fluctuations $d\mathbf{u}$ and $d\mathbf{u}'$, the squared determinant identity is

$$\det((d\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})(d\mathbf{u}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})) = (d\mathbf{u} \cdot d\mathbf{u}')^2 + \frac{1}{4} \|[d\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, d\mathbf{u}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}]\|^2. \quad (6.55)$$

For orthogonal fluctuations this reduces to

$$\det((d\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})(d\mathbf{u}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})) = \frac{1}{4} \|[d\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, d\mathbf{u}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}]\|^2. \quad (6.56)$$

About the third axis, define

$$\mathbf{a}_{\pm} := \frac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \pm i\boldsymbol{\sigma}_2), \quad \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{\pm} := \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{I}_2 \pm \boldsymbol{\sigma}_3). \quad (6.57)$$

Then

$$[\boldsymbol{\sigma}_3, \mathbf{a}_{\pm}] = \pm 2\mathbf{a}_{\pm}, \quad \mathbf{a}_{\pm}^2 = 0, \quad \mathbf{a}_{\pm}\mathbf{a}_{\mp} = \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{\pm}, \quad (6.58)$$

$$\boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 = \mathbf{a}_{+} + \mathbf{a}_{-}, \quad \boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 = (\mathbf{a}_{+} - \mathbf{a}_{-})/i, \quad \boldsymbol{\sigma}_3 = \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{+} - \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{-}. \quad (6.59)$$

Their projector action is

$$\mathbf{a}_{+}\boldsymbol{\Pi}_{+} = 0, \quad \mathbf{a}_{+}\boldsymbol{\Pi}_{-} = \mathbf{a}_{+}, \quad \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{+}\mathbf{a}_{+} = \mathbf{a}_{+}, \quad \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{-}\mathbf{a}_{+} = 0, \quad (6.60)$$

$$\mathbf{a}_{-}\boldsymbol{\Pi}_{-} = 0, \quad \mathbf{a}_{-}\boldsymbol{\Pi}_{+} = \mathbf{a}_{-}, \quad \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{-}\mathbf{a}_{-} = \mathbf{a}_{-}, \quad \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{+}\mathbf{a}_{-} = 0. \quad (6.61)$$

Finally, on the mass shell let

$$U = \frac{E + \mathbf{P} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}}{m}, \quad \boldsymbol{\Lambda}_{\pm} = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{I} \pm \mathbf{W}(U)). \quad (6.62)$$

Since $\det(U) = 1$ and $\mathbf{W}(U)^2 = \mathbf{I}$, the positive- and negative-energy projectors satisfy

$$\boldsymbol{\Lambda}_{\pm}^2 = \boldsymbol{\Lambda}_{\pm}, \quad \boldsymbol{\Lambda}_{+}\boldsymbol{\Lambda}_{-} = 0, \quad \boldsymbol{\Lambda}_{+} + \boldsymbol{\Lambda}_{-} = \mathbf{I}. \quad (6.63)$$

Lift the spin projectors to the Dirac block space by

$$\boldsymbol{\Pi}_{j,4} := \text{diag}(\boldsymbol{\Pi}_j, \boldsymbol{\Pi}_j), \quad j = \pm. \quad (6.64)$$

When $[\boldsymbol{\Lambda}_i, \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{j,4}] = 0$, as for a compatible spin quantization axis, their products are joint energy-spin projectors and resolve the physical Dirac column selected in Section 6.2 into four sectors:

$$\boldsymbol{\Psi} = \sum_{i=\pm} \sum_{j=\pm} \boldsymbol{\Psi}_{ij}, \quad \boldsymbol{\Psi}_{ij} = \boldsymbol{\Lambda}_i \boldsymbol{\Pi}_{j,4} \boldsymbol{\Psi}. \quad (6.65)$$

Without this commutation condition the displayed sum remains a sequential decomposition, but the factors are not joint orthogonal projectors.

7 Rotations and Lorentz boosts

7.1 Rotors

A rotation through angle ϕ about unit axis $\mathbf{u}$ is generated by

$$R = \exp\left(\frac{\phi}{2} \mathbf{u} \cdot i\boldsymbol{\sigma}\right) = \cos \frac{\phi}{2} + \mathbf{u} \cdot i\boldsymbol{\sigma} \sin \frac{\phi}{2}, \quad R^{-1} = R^{\text{H}}. \quad (7.1)$$

The sandwich action $X' = R^H X R$ fixes the scalar component and rotates the spatial vector according to Rodrigues' formula,

$$\mathbf{r}' = \mathbf{r} \cos \phi + (\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{r}) \sin \phi + (\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{r})(1 - \cos \phi)\mathbf{u}. \quad (7.2)$$

The half-angle explains the spinorial sign change $R(\phi + 2\pi) = -R(\phi)$. In the physical column representation, let $\mathbf{R} := \text{mat}(R)$ and define the pure-state density matrix

$$\rho_\chi := \frac{\chi \chi^H}{\chi^H \chi} = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{I}_2 + \mathbf{s} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}). \quad (7.3)$$

For $\chi' = \mathbf{R}\chi$,

$$\rho_{\chi'} = \mathbf{R} \rho_\chi \mathbf{R}^H, \quad \text{tr}(\rho_{\chi'} \text{mat}(Z)) = \text{tr}(\rho_\chi \mathbf{R}^H \text{mat}(Z) \mathbf{R}). \quad (7.4)$$

Thus rotating the state is dual to conjugating the observable. For a spinor $\psi_R := R\psi$, expectation values transform as

$$\psi_R^H = \psi^H R^H, \quad \langle Z \rangle_{\psi_R} = \frac{\text{sc}(\psi^H R^H Z R \psi)}{\text{sc}(\psi^H \psi)}, \quad R^H = R^{-1}. \quad (7.5)$$

For $Z = \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$, this gives $Z' = R^H Z R = \mathbf{u}' \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$.

7.2 Boosts

Let rapidity θ satisfy $\beta = \tanh \theta$ and $\gamma = \cosh \theta$. A boost along $\mathbf{u}$ is

$$L = \exp\left(-\frac{\theta}{2} \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}\right), \quad L^H = L, \quad L^{-1} = L^*. \quad (7.6)$$

For $\psi_L := L\psi$, the boost generator is Hermitian, so

$$\psi_L^H = \psi^H L, \quad \langle Z \rangle_{\psi_L} = \frac{\text{sc}(\psi^H L Z L \psi)}{\text{sc}(\psi^H L^2 \psi)}. \quad (7.7)$$

The similarity $L^{-1} Z L$ is a different operation: it preserves $\text{sc}(Z)$ and is not the spacetime or spinor-bilinear boost used here. The spacetime paravector therefore transforms by the Hermitian congruence $X' = L X L$, which yields the components $\mathbf{r}_\parallel = (\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{u})\mathbf{u}$, $\mathbf{r}_\perp = \mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}_\parallel$, $\mathbf{r}'_\parallel = (\mathbf{r}' \cdot \mathbf{u})\mathbf{u}$, and $\mathbf{r}'_\perp = \mathbf{r}' - \mathbf{r}'_\parallel$:

$$t' = \gamma(t - \beta \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{r}), \quad (7.8)$$

$$\mathbf{r}'_\parallel = \gamma(\mathbf{r}_\parallel - \beta t \mathbf{u}), \quad \mathbf{r}'_\perp = \mathbf{r}_\perp. \quad (7.9)$$

It preserves $\det(X) = t^2 - \mathbf{r}^2$. The electromagnetic field instead obeys $F' = L F L^*$ for $F = (\mathbf{E} + \mathbf{B}i) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$. Define $\mathbf{E}_\parallel = (\mathbf{E} \cdot \mathbf{u})\mathbf{u}$, $\mathbf{E}_\perp = \mathbf{E} - \mathbf{E}_\parallel$ and likewise $\mathbf{E}'_\parallel = (\mathbf{E}' \cdot \mathbf{u})\mathbf{u}$, $\mathbf{E}'_\perp = \mathbf{E}' - \mathbf{E}'_\parallel$; define the four corresponding components of $\mathbf{B}$ and $\mathbf{B}'$ by the same formulas. Then

$$\mathbf{E}'_\parallel = \mathbf{E}_\parallel, \quad \mathbf{E}'_\perp = \gamma(\mathbf{E}_\perp + \beta \mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{B}), \quad (7.10)$$

$$\mathbf{B}'_\parallel = \mathbf{B}_\parallel, \quad \mathbf{B}'_\perp = \gamma(\mathbf{B}_\perp - \beta \mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{E}). \quad (7.11)$$

7.3 Congruences, transformed bases, and non-inertial terms

Spinor bilinears use the Hermitian congruence $Y = T^H X T$. With $d\Theta = T^{-1} dT$, direct differentiation gives the ancillary identity

$$dY = T^H(dX)T + (d\Theta)^H Y + Y d\Theta. \quad (7.12)$$

For a rotation, $T^H = T^{-1}$ and $(d\Theta)^H = -d\Theta$, so this reduces to a commutator. For a Hermitian boost it does not: the two connection terms form the congruence appropriate to the spinor bilinear.

Transformed algebra bases use the distinct similarity transformation. For any invertible T , let $X' = T^{-1} X T$ and $d\Theta = T^{-1} dT$. Differentiation gives the useful connection terms

$$dX' = T^{-1}(dX)T + [X', d\Theta], \quad (7.13)$$

$$d^2 X' = T^{-1}(d^2 X)T + 2[dX', d\Theta] + [X', d^2 \Theta] + [d\Theta, [X', d\Theta]]. \quad (7.14)$$

In time-parametrized form, $\Omega = T^{-1} dT/dt$ gives

$$\frac{dX'}{dt} = T^{-1} \frac{dX}{dt} T + [X', \Omega], \quad (7.15)$$

$$\frac{d^2 X'}{dt^2} = T^{-1} \frac{d^2 X}{dt^2} T + 2 \left[\frac{dX'}{dt}, \Omega \right] + \left[X', \frac{d\Omega}{dt} \right] + [\Omega, [X', \Omega]]. \quad (7.16)$$

The transformed generators $\sigma'_n = T^{-1} \sigma_n T$ obey the same algebra, including $(\sigma'_n)^2 = 1$ and $\sigma'_1 \sigma'_2 \sigma'_3 = i$, and

$$d\sigma'_n = [\sigma'_n, T^{-1} dT]. \quad (7.17)$$

If $T = f + \mathbf{g} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$, then

$$T^{-1} = \frac{f - \mathbf{g} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}}{f^2 - \mathbf{g}^2}, \quad (7.18)$$

$$T^{-1} dT = \frac{f df - \mathbf{g} \cdot d\mathbf{g}}{f^2 - \mathbf{g}^2} + \frac{f d\mathbf{g} - df \mathbf{g} - i\mathbf{g} \times d\mathbf{g}}{f^2 - \mathbf{g}^2} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (7.19)$$

Write the vector part of Ω in the primed basis as

$$\text{vec}(\Omega) = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{k} + i\boldsymbol{\omega}), \quad k_n + i\omega_n = \text{sc}(2(dT/dt)T^{-1}\sigma_n). \quad (7.20)$$

Then

$$\frac{d\boldsymbol{\sigma}'}{dt} = (-\boldsymbol{\omega} + i\mathbf{k}) \times \boldsymbol{\sigma}', \quad (7.21)$$

and, for $Z = S + \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}'$,

$$\frac{dZ}{dt} = \frac{dS}{dt} + \left(\frac{d\mathbf{V}}{dt} - \mathbf{V} \times \boldsymbol{\omega} + i\mathbf{V} \times \mathbf{k} \right) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}'. \quad (7.22)$$

For $X = t + \mathbf{r} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}'$ these are the rotational and boost-like inertial terms in the measured velocity. When $T^{-1} = \text{adj}(T)$, the transformed basis satisfies $\text{adj}(\sigma'_n) = -\sigma'_n$ and $\det(Z) = S^2 - \mathbf{V}^2$ for $Z = S + \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}'$.

Collinear boosts add rapidities and therefore obey

$$\beta' = \frac{\beta_1 + \beta_2}{1 + \beta_1 \beta_2}, \quad \gamma' = \gamma_1 \gamma_2 (1 + \beta_1 \beta_2). \quad (7.23)$$

Inversion changes product order:

$$(LR)^{-1} = R^H L^*, \quad (RL)^{-1} = L^* R^H, \quad (R_1 R_2)^{-1} = R_2^H R_1^H, \quad (L_1 L_2)^{-1} = L_2^* L_1^*. \quad (7.24)$$

8 Generalized spacetime and metric form

Let

$$X = f(t, \mathbf{r}) + \mathbf{g}(t, \mathbf{r}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad dX = df + d\mathbf{g} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (8.1)$$

Writing $dX = A dt + \mathbf{B} \cdot d\mathbf{r}$ gives

$$A = \partial_t f + \partial_t \mathbf{g} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad \mathbf{B} = \partial_{\mathbf{r}} f + \partial_{\mathbf{r}} (\mathbf{g} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}), \quad (8.2)$$

and the interval remains

$$ds^2 = dX dX^* = df^2 - d\mathbf{g}^2. \quad (8.3)$$

Define the geometric velocity and Lorentz factor by

$$\mathbf{v} = \frac{d\mathbf{g}}{df}, \quad \gamma = \frac{df}{ds} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 - \mathbf{v}^2}}, \quad U = \gamma(1 + \mathbf{v} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}). \quad (8.4)$$

With geometric acceleration $\mathbf{a} = d\mathbf{v}/ds = \gamma d^2\mathbf{g}/df^2$, the proper-acceleration formula is unchanged. Inertial motion $dU/ds = 0$ implies $\mathbf{a} = 0$, hence $\mathbf{g} = c_1 f + c_2$ and constant geometric velocity. If $f' = df/dt$ and $\mathbf{g}' = d\mathbf{g}/dt$, then

$$\frac{d\mathbf{v}}{dt} = \frac{\mathbf{g}'' f' - \mathbf{g}' f''}{(f')^2}, \quad [U, dU/ds] = 2\gamma^3(\mathbf{v} \times \mathbf{a}) \cdot \mathbf{i}\boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (8.5)$$

In coordinates $\mathbf{x} = \{t, r_1, r_2, r_3\}^\top$, write

$$ds^2 = d\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{Q}(\mathbf{x}) d\mathbf{x}. \quad (8.6)$$

For real symmetric $\mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{N} \mathbf{D} \mathbf{N}^\top$ with eigenvalues λ_n and orthonormal eigenvectors $\mathbf{u}_n$,

$$ds^2 = \sum_n \lambda_n (\mathbf{u}_n \cdot d\mathbf{x})^2, \quad dx'_n = \sqrt{\lambda_n} \mathbf{u}_n \cdot d\mathbf{x}, \quad \mathbf{Q}^{-1} = \mathbf{N} \mathbf{D}^{-1} \mathbf{N}^\top. \quad (8.7)$$

9 Reference summary

This index collects the principal definitions and results in natural units, with signature $(+, -, -, -)$. Topic titles and equation numbers link to their full statements and derivations.

Algebra and vector operations.

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_n \sigma_m &= \delta_{nm} + \epsilon_{nmk} \mathbf{i} \sigma_k, & [\sigma_n, \sigma_m] &= 2\epsilon_{nmk} \mathbf{i} \sigma_k & (1.6), \\ (\mathbf{A} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma})(\mathbf{B} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) &= \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B} + \mathbf{i}(\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, & \mathbf{A}^2 &= \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{A}, \\ \|Z\|^2 &= \|S\|^2 + \|\mathbf{V}\|^2, & \|\mathbf{V}\|^2 &= \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}^* = \mathbf{V}^* \cdot \mathbf{V} & (3.38). \end{aligned}$$

Hermitian and sigma-conjugate operators.

$$\begin{aligned} (ZZ')^* &= Z^* Z'^*, & (ZZ')^H &= Z'^H Z^H, \\ \text{adj}(Z) &= Z^{*H}, & \text{adj}(ZZ') &= Z'^{*H} Z^{*H} & (3.5). \end{aligned}$$

Paravectors, extraction, and products. For $Z = S + \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} = (a + bi) + (\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B}i) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$,

$$\begin{aligned}
S &= \text{sc}(Z) = \frac{1}{2}(Z + Z^{*\text{H}}), & \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} &= \frac{1}{2}(Z - Z^{*\text{H}}), \\
a &= \text{sc}(\text{re}(Z)), & b &= \text{sc}(\text{im}(Z)), \\
\mathbf{A} &= \text{vec}(\text{re}(Z)), & \mathbf{B} &= \text{vec}(\text{im}(Z)), \\
ZZ' &= (SS' + \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}') + (S\mathbf{V}' + S'\mathbf{V} + i\mathbf{V} \times \mathbf{V}') \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \\
\det(Z) &= \text{adj}(Z) Z = Z \text{adj}(Z) = S^2 - \mathbf{V}^2, & Z^{-1} &= \frac{\text{adj}(Z)}{\det(Z)}, \\
Z^2 - 2SZ + (S^2 - \mathbf{V}^2) &= 0, \\
\lambda_{\pm} &= S \pm \sqrt{\mathbf{V}^2}.
\end{aligned}$$

See the product (3.33), determinant (3.7), and quadratic identity (3.46).

Projection operators and functions.

$$\begin{aligned}
\Pi_{\pm} &= \frac{1}{2}(1 \pm \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}), & \Pi_{\pm}^2 &= \Pi_{\pm}, & \Pi_+ \Pi_- &= 0, \\
f(\mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) &= f(1)\Pi_+ + f(-1)\Pi_-, \\
X &= \lambda_+ \Pi_+ + \lambda_- \Pi_-, & f(X) &= f(\lambda_+)\Pi_+ + f(\lambda_-)\Pi_-.
\end{aligned}$$

Pauli-matrix representation.

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{mat}(Z) &= \begin{pmatrix} S + V_3 & V_1 - iV_2 \\ V_1 + iV_2 & S - V_3 \end{pmatrix}, & \text{tr}(\mathbf{M}) &= 2S & (\text{A.2}), \\
\mathbf{M}^{\text{H}} &= (\mathbf{M}^{\text{C}})^{\text{T}} = (\mathbf{M}^{\text{T}})^{\text{C}}, & \mathbf{M}^* &= -\mathbf{J}\mathbf{M}^{\text{C}}\mathbf{J}, \\
\text{mat}(\text{adj}(Z)) &= \text{adj}(\mathbf{M}), & \text{adj}(\mathbf{M}) &= \text{tr}(\mathbf{M})\mathbf{I}_2 - \mathbf{M}.
\end{aligned}$$

Space-time kinematics and action.

$$\begin{aligned}
dX &= dt + d\mathbf{r} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, & ds^2 &= dX dX^* = dt^2 - d\mathbf{r}^2 & (4.2), \\
U &= \gamma(1 + \mathbf{v} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}), & \gamma &= (1 - \mathbf{v}^2)^{-1/2}, \\
mU &= E + \mathbf{P} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, & E^2 - \mathbf{P}^2 &= m^2 & (4.11), \\
\int L dt &= -m \int ds, & L &= -m/\gamma, & H &= m\gamma.
\end{aligned}$$

Electromagnetism.

$$\begin{aligned}
\partial &= \partial_t + \boldsymbol{\sigma} \cdot \partial_{\mathbf{r}}, & F &= (\mathbf{E} + \mathbf{B}i) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, & D &= \rho + \mathbf{J} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \\
\partial F &= D^* = \rho - \mathbf{J} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, & \square &= \partial^* \partial & (5.2), \\
\partial \Phi &= S + F^*, & \mathbf{E} &= -\partial_t \mathbf{A} - \partial_{\mathbf{r}} V, & \mathbf{B} &= \partial_{\mathbf{r}} \times \mathbf{A}, \\
\frac{1}{2}F^2 &= \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{E}^2 - \mathbf{B}^2) + i\mathbf{E} \cdot \mathbf{B}, & \frac{1}{2}FF^{\text{H}} &= \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{E}^2 + \mathbf{B}^2) + (\mathbf{E} \times \mathbf{B}) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \\
m \frac{dU}{ds} &= q \text{re}(FU), & \frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} &= q(\mathbf{E} + \mathbf{v} \times \mathbf{B}) & (5.43).
\end{aligned}$$

Wave equations, spin, and energy sectors.

$$\begin{aligned}
\langle \psi' | \psi \rangle &= \text{sc}(\psi'^{\text{H}} \psi) = \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\mathbf{M}_{\psi'}^{\text{H}} \mathbf{M}_{\psi}), \\
\langle \psi' | Z | \psi \rangle &= \text{sc}(\psi'^{\text{H}} Z \psi) = \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\mathbf{M}_{\psi'}^{\text{H}} \text{mat}(Z) \mathbf{M}_{\psi}), \\
\langle Z \rangle_{\psi} &= \frac{\langle \psi | Z | \psi \rangle}{\langle \psi | \psi \rangle} = \frac{\text{sc}(\psi^{\text{H}} Z \psi)}{\text{sc}(\psi^{\text{H}} \psi)}, \\
(\square + m^2) \Psi &= 0, \\
\mathbf{W}(Z) &= \begin{pmatrix} 0 & Z \\ \text{adj}(Z) & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \\
(\mathbf{W}(\text{i}\partial) - m\mathbf{I}) \Psi &= 0, \\
(\mathbf{W}(\text{i}\partial - q\Phi^*) - m\mathbf{I}) \Psi &= 0, \\
\text{i}\partial_t \Psi &= \left(\frac{(-\text{i}\partial_{\mathbf{r}} - q\mathbf{A})^2}{2m} + qV - \frac{q}{2m} \mathbf{B} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right) \Psi, \\
\mathbf{\Pi}_{\pm}(\mathbf{u}) &= \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{I}_2 \pm \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}), \\
p_{\pm}(\mathbf{u}) &= \frac{1}{2}(1 \pm \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{s}), \\
\mathbf{\Lambda}_{\pm} &= \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{I} \pm \mathbf{W}(U)), \quad \mathbf{\Pi}_{j,4} = \text{diag}(\mathbf{\Pi}_j, \mathbf{\Pi}_j), \\
\Psi &= \sum_{i=\pm} \sum_{j=\pm} \Psi_{ij}, \quad \Psi_{ij} = \mathbf{\Lambda}_i \mathbf{\Pi}_{j,4} \Psi.
\end{aligned}$$

See the paravector inner product (6.1), minimal-ideal spinor (6.13), Klein–Gordon equation (6.15), Dirac equations (6.20) and (6.23), Pauli equation (6.24), and spin probability (6.52).

Rotations, boosts, and transformed bases.

$$\begin{aligned}
R &= \exp(\phi \mathbf{u} \cdot \text{i}\boldsymbol{\sigma}/2), \quad R^{\text{H}} = R^{-1}, \quad Z' = R^{\text{H}} Z R, \\
L &= \exp(-\theta \mathbf{u} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}/2), \quad L^{\text{H}} = L, \quad X' = L X L, \\
\langle Z \rangle_{\psi_T} &= \frac{\text{sc}(\psi^{\text{H}} T^{\text{H}} Z T \psi)}{\text{sc}(\psi^{\text{H}} T^{\text{H}} T \psi)}, \\
\text{d}(T^{\text{H}} X T) &= T^{\text{H}}(\text{d}X)T + (\text{d}\Theta)^{\text{H}} T^{\text{H}} X T + T^{\text{H}} X T \text{d}\Theta, \\
X' &= T^{-1} X T, \\
\text{d}X' &= T^{-1}(\text{d}X)T + [X', T^{-1} \text{d}T].
\end{aligned}$$

See the bilinear rule (6.4) and congruence derivative (7.12).

Quaternion appendix.

$$\mathbf{q} = -\text{i}\boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad Q^{\text{H}} = a - \mathbf{b} \cdot \mathbf{q}, \quad Q Q^{\text{H}} = a^2 + \mathbf{b}^2.$$

Generalized spacetime and metric form.

$$\begin{aligned}
X &= f + \mathbf{g} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, & \text{d}s^2 &= \text{d}f^2 - \text{d}\mathbf{g}^2, \\
\mathbf{v} &= \text{d}\mathbf{g}/\text{d}f, & U &= \gamma(1 + \mathbf{v} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}), \\
\text{d}s^2 &= \text{d}\mathbf{x}^{\text{T}} \mathbf{Q}(\mathbf{x}) \text{d}\mathbf{x}, & \mathbf{Q} &= \mathbf{N} \mathbf{D} \mathbf{N}^{\text{T}}.
\end{aligned}$$

A Pauli-matrix representation

A.1 Faithful representation

Every complex element of the displayed algebra basis can be collected as

$$\begin{aligned} Z &= S + \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \\ S &\in \mathbb{C}, \quad \mathbf{V} \in \mathbb{C}^3. \end{aligned} \tag{A.1}$$

Such an element is called a complex paravector. Its faithful 2×2 complex representation begins with

$$\text{mat}(\sigma_1) = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \text{mat}(\sigma_2) = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -i \\ i & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \text{mat}(\sigma_3) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Thus

$$\text{mat}(S + \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) = \begin{pmatrix} S + V_3 & V_1 - iV_2 \\ V_1 + iV_2 & S - V_3 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{A.2}$$

It preserves identity, addition, and multiplied order:

$$\text{mat}(1) = \mathbf{I}_2, \quad \text{mat}(Z'Z) = \text{mat}(Z') \text{mat}(Z). \tag{A.3}$$

A.2 Matrix operations and induced algebra operations

Let $\mathbf{M} = \text{mat}(Z)$ with entries $m_{jk} = a_{jk} + b_{jk}i$, where $a_{jk}, b_{jk} \in \mathbb{R}$. Define transpose by

$$(\mathbf{M}^\top)_{jk} := m_{kj}. \tag{A.4}$$

Define entrywise complex conjugation independently by

$$m_{jk}^c := a_{jk} - b_{jk}i, \quad \mathbf{M}^c := \begin{pmatrix} m_{11}^c & m_{12}^c \\ m_{21}^c & m_{22}^c \end{pmatrix}. \tag{A.5}$$

The Hermitian transpose is then

$$\mathbf{M}^H := (\mathbf{M}^c)^\top = (\mathbf{M}^\top)^c. \tag{A.6}$$

Define the algebra operation H through the faithful representation by

$$\text{mat}(Z^H) := \mathbf{M}^H. \tag{A.7}$$

Its action on every basis type is

$$\text{mat}(1)^H = \mathbf{I}_2, \tag{A.8}$$

$$(i\mathbf{I}_2)^H = -i\mathbf{I}_2, \tag{A.9}$$

$$\text{mat}(\sigma_n)^H = \text{mat}(\sigma_n), \quad n = 1, 2, 3, \tag{A.10}$$

$$\text{mat}(i\sigma_n)^H = -\text{mat}(i\sigma_n), \quad n = 1, 2, 3. \tag{A.11}$$

Hence $1^H = 1$, $i^H = -i$, $\sigma_n^H = \sigma_n$, and $(i\sigma_n)^H = -i\sigma_n$. Hermitian conjugation changes matrix-product order. Therefore faithfulness gives

$$\text{mat}((\sigma_n \sigma_m)^H) = (\text{mat}(\sigma_n) \text{mat}(\sigma_m))^H \tag{A.12}$$

$$= \text{mat}(\sigma_m)^H \text{mat}(\sigma_n)^H = \text{mat}(\sigma_m \sigma_n), \tag{A.13}$$

and hence

$$(\sigma_n \sigma_m)^H = \sigma_m^H \sigma_n^H = \sigma_m \sigma_n. \quad (\text{A.14})$$

Thus H is precisely the Hermitian operator defined in Section 2. To define the distinct sigma conjugation, let $\mathbf{J} := \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ and $\mathbf{J}^2 = -\mathbf{I}_2$, and set

$$\mathbf{M}^* := -\mathbf{J} \mathbf{M}^C \mathbf{J}, \quad \text{mat}(\mathbf{Z}^*) := \mathbf{M}^*. \quad (\text{A.15})$$

This gives the required action on every basis type:

$$\text{mat}(1)^* = -\mathbf{J} \mathbf{I}_2^C \mathbf{J} = \mathbf{I}_2, \quad (\text{A.16})$$

$$(\mathbf{i} \mathbf{I}_2)^* = -\mathbf{J} (\mathbf{i} \mathbf{I}_2)^C \mathbf{J} = -\mathbf{i} \mathbf{I}_2, \quad (\text{A.17})$$

$$\text{mat}(\sigma_n)^* = -\mathbf{J} \text{mat}(\sigma_n)^C \mathbf{J} = -\text{mat}(\sigma_n), \quad n = 1, 2, 3, \quad (\text{A.18})$$

$$\text{mat}(\mathbf{i} \sigma_n)^* = -\mathbf{J} \text{mat}(\mathbf{i} \sigma_n)^C \mathbf{J} = \text{mat}(\mathbf{i} \sigma_n), \quad n = 1, 2, 3. \quad (\text{A.19})$$

The operation also preserves multiplied order. Since entrywise conjugation preserves order and $\mathbf{J}^2 = -\mathbf{I}_2$,

$$(\mathbf{M} \mathbf{N})^* := -\mathbf{J} (\mathbf{M} \mathbf{N})^C \mathbf{J} = -\mathbf{J} \mathbf{M}^C \mathbf{N}^C \mathbf{J}, \quad (\text{A.20})$$

$$\mathbf{M}^* \mathbf{N}^* = (-\mathbf{J} \mathbf{M}^C \mathbf{J}) (-\mathbf{J} \mathbf{N}^C \mathbf{J}) = -\mathbf{J} \mathbf{M}^C \mathbf{N}^C \mathbf{J}. \quad (\text{A.21})$$

Therefore

$$(\mathbf{M} \mathbf{N})^* = \mathbf{M}^* \mathbf{N}^*. \quad (\text{A.22})$$

The four operations must remain distinct:

symbol	matrix operation	relation to the algebra
$\mathbf{M}^T$	transpose	changes matrix-product order
$\mathbf{M}^C$	entrywise complex conjugation	sends $\mathbf{i}$ to $-\mathbf{i}$
$\mathbf{M}^H$	Hermitian transpose	$\text{mat}(\mathbf{Z}^H)$
$\mathbf{M}^*$	sigma conjugation	$\text{mat}(\mathbf{Z}^*)$

Their product-order rules are

$$(\mathbf{M} \mathbf{N})^T = \mathbf{N}^T \mathbf{M}^T, \quad (\mathbf{M} \mathbf{N})^C = \mathbf{M}^C \mathbf{N}^C, \quad (\text{A.23})$$

$$(\mathbf{M} \mathbf{N})^H = \mathbf{N}^H \mathbf{M}^H. \quad (\text{A.24})$$

Sigma conjugation preserves order by equation (A.22). Thus the induced algebra operations satisfy

$$(Z^H)^H = Z, \quad (ZZ')^H = Z'^H Z^H, \quad (\text{A.25})$$

$$(Z^*)^* = Z, \quad (ZZ')^* = Z^* Z'^*, \quad (\text{A.26})$$

$$Z^{*H} = Z^{H*}. \quad (\text{A.27})$$

Trace, determinant, and adjugate. For $\mathbf{M} = \text{mat}(Z)$, define the matrix trace and determinant by

$$\text{tr}(\mathbf{M}) := m_{11} + m_{22}, \quad \det(\mathbf{M}) := m_{11}m_{22} - m_{12}m_{21}. \quad (\text{A.28})$$

The corresponding paravector operations are

$$\text{tr}(Z) := \text{tr}(\mathbf{M}) = 2S, \quad \det(Z) := \det(\mathbf{M}). \quad (\text{A.29})$$

Faithfulness transfers the matrix identities to the algebra:

$$\text{tr}(Z + Z') = \text{tr}(Z) + \text{tr}(Z'), \quad \text{tr}(cZ) = c \text{tr}(Z), \quad (\text{A.30})$$

$$\text{tr}(ZZ') = \text{tr}(Z'Z), \quad (\text{A.31})$$

$$\det(ZZ') = \det(Z) \det(Z'), \quad \det(cZ) = c^2 \det(Z) \quad (c \in \mathbb{C}). \quad (\text{A.32})$$

For a 2×2 matrix and its paravector preimage, define

$$\text{adj}(\mathbf{M}) := \text{tr}(\mathbf{M})\mathbf{I}_2 - \mathbf{M}, \quad (\text{A.33})$$

$$\text{mat}(\text{adj}(Z)) := \text{adj}(\mathbf{M}). \quad (\text{A.34})$$

Direct comparison with the induced algebra operators gives

$$\text{adj}(Z) = Z^{*\text{H}}, \quad \text{mat}(\text{adj}(Z)) = \text{adj}(\mathbf{M}) = (\mathbf{M}^*)^{\text{H}}. \quad (\text{A.35})$$

Equivalently,

$$\text{adj}(Z) = \text{tr}(Z) - Z, \quad \text{tr}(Z) = Z + \text{adj}(Z) = 2S. \quad (\text{A.36})$$

The adjugate changes product order and obeys

$$\text{adj}(ZZ') = \text{adj}(Z') \text{adj}(Z), \quad \text{adj}(\text{adj}(Z)) = Z, \quad (\text{A.37})$$

$$\text{adj}(Z) Z = Z \text{adj}(Z) = \det(Z), \quad \text{mat}(\text{adj}(Z) Z) = \det(\mathbf{M})\mathbf{I}_2. \quad (\text{A.38})$$

Consequently, when $\det(Z) \neq 0$,

$$Z^{-1} = \frac{\text{adj}(Z)}{\det(Z)}. \quad (\text{A.39})$$

Finally, Cayley–Hamilton gives

$$\mathbf{M}^2 - \text{tr}(\mathbf{M})\mathbf{M} + \det(\mathbf{M})\mathbf{I}_2 = 0, \quad (\text{A.40})$$

$$Z^2 - \text{tr}(Z)Z + \det(Z) = 0. \quad (\text{A.41})$$

A.3 Algebra–matrix crosswalk

For $Z = S + \mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$, define

$$\text{sc}(Z) := S, \quad \text{vec}(Z) := \mathbf{V}. \quad (\text{A.42})$$

Thus $\text{vec}(Z)$ is the coefficient vector, while its algebra element is $\mathbf{V} \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}$.

For $\mathbf{M} = \text{mat}(Z)$, the extraction formulas are

$$\text{sc}(Z) = S = \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\mathbf{M}), \quad \text{mat}(\text{sc}(Z)) = S\mathbf{I}_2, \quad (\text{A.43})$$

$$(\text{vec}(Z))_n = V_n = \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}_n \mathbf{M}), \quad \text{mat}(\text{vec}(Z) \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}) = \mathbf{M} - \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\mathbf{M})\mathbf{I}_2. \quad (\text{A.44})$$

Define real and imaginary paravector extraction through Hermitian splitting:

$$\text{mat}(\text{re}(Z)) := \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{M} + \mathbf{M}^{\text{H}}), \quad (\text{A.45})$$

$$\text{mat}(\text{im}(Z)) := \frac{\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}^{\text{H}}}{2\text{i}}. \quad (\text{A.46})$$

By construction, the algebra and matrix operators agree through

$$\text{mat}(Z^{\text{H}}) = \mathbf{M}^{\text{H}}, \quad \text{mat}(Z^*) = \mathbf{M}^*, \quad \text{mat}(Z^{*\text{H}}) = (\mathbf{M}^*)^{\text{H}}. \quad (\text{A.47})$$

The matrix-only operations $^{\text{C}}$ and $^{\text{T}}$ are related to the algebra operations by

$$\mathbf{M}^{\text{C}} = -\mathbf{J}\mathbf{M}^*\mathbf{J}, \quad \mathbf{M}^{\text{T}} = -\mathbf{J}\text{mat}(Z^{*\text{H}})\mathbf{J}. \quad (\text{A.48})$$

Finally, scalar extraction of a product and the paravector coefficient norm are

$$\text{sc}(Z'Z) = \frac{1}{2}\text{tr}(\mathbf{M}_{Z'}\mathbf{M}_Z), \quad (\text{A.49})$$

$$\|Z\|^2 := \frac{1}{2}\text{tr}(\mathbf{M}^{\text{H}}\mathbf{M}) = \frac{1}{2}\text{tr}(\mathbf{M}\mathbf{M}^{\text{H}}). \quad (\text{A.50})$$

B Quaternion subalgebra

Define

$$q_1 = -\sigma_2\sigma_3, \quad q_2 = -\sigma_3\sigma_1, \quad q_3 = -\sigma_1\sigma_2, \quad \mathbf{q} = -\text{i}\boldsymbol{\sigma}. \quad (\text{B.1})$$

Then $q_1^2 = q_2^2 = q_3^2 = q_1q_2q_3 = -1$. A quaternion $Q = a + \mathbf{b} \cdot \mathbf{q}$ satisfies $Q^{\text{H}} = a - \mathbf{b} \cdot \mathbf{q}$ and $QQ^{\text{H}} = a^2 + \mathbf{b}^2$; the rotation action is $\mathbf{r}' \cdot \mathbf{q} = Q(\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{q})Q^{\text{H}}$.

Conventions and cautions

- The same symbol $\text{i} = \sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_3$ is both the algebra's pseudoscalar and, in the Pauli representation, the ordinary complex unit.
- Sigma conjugation $(\cdot)^*$, the Hermitian operator $(\cdot)^{\text{H}}$, and their composition are distinct. In the Pauli representation, the Hermitian operator corresponds to Hermitian adjunction.
- $\det(Z)$ is an indefinite quadratic form and may be complex for complex Z .
- Differential operators act on everything to their right unless parentheses state otherwise. This matters in products involving fields.

*Editorial notation record.*¹

¹Compared with `tmp.txt`, the following presentation and style changes were made. Vectors and matrices are bold, and only vectors and matrices are bold; in particular, the electromagnetic fields formerly written as calligraphic or italic E and B are the upright bold vectors $\mathbf{E}$ and $\mathbf{B}$, while the scalar energy remains the unbold symbol E . The action is written as $\int L \text{d}t$, avoiding conflict with the scalar part S ; the Lagrangian L and Hamiltonian H use the regular math font rather than decorative alphabets. Blackboard bold is retained only for the number sets $\mathbb{R}$ and $\mathbb{C}$. The Dirac block function is the upright bold $\mathbf{W}(\cdot)$. A vector square is explicitly defined by $\mathbf{A}^2 := \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{A}$. Curly braces are reserved for explicit vector-entry lists, and commutators alone use square brackets. Parentheses delimit matrices, functions, algebraic grouping, and order-sensitive operator products; redundant grouping parentheses were removed. The extraction functions $\text{sc}(\cdot)$, $\text{vec}(\cdot)$, $\text{re}(\cdot)$, and $\text{im}(\cdot)$ replace `scalar`, `vector`, and capitalized variants and are defined before use; the unused expectation abbreviation `Exp` was removed. The original metric notation $\langle\langle Z \rangle\rangle^2$ and every determinant bar were replaced by the unambiguous function notation $\det(Z)$. Double bars are reserved for

squared scalar, vector, and coefficient norms, with $\|Z\|^2 = \|S\|^2 + \|\mathbf{V}\|^2$; absolute-value bars are not used. Entrywise complex-conjugation notation is confined to the matrix section. Sigma conjugation retains the splat `*`; the operator originally written `R` and elsewhere as a dagger is written `H` because it changes the multiplied sigma order and becomes Hermitian adjunction in the matrix representation. The abbreviation $\text{adj}(Z) := Z^{*\text{H}}$ is defined early and used where it shortens formulas. The matrix section uses matching upright sans-serif capitals `T`, `C`, and `H` for transpose, entrywise complex conjugation, and Hermitian transpose, and distinguishes these from sigma conjugation, including which operations change product order. Plus/minus labels are subscripts (`±`, `+`, `-`), not superscripts or parenthesized labels. Parallel and perpendicular components use `∥` and `⊥` rather than `par` and `prp`, with their projection formulas restated locally at each use. Spatial derivatives use `$\partial_r$` rather than `$\nabla$` , and no overbars are used. Literal or malformed source spacing and fraction commands such as `quad` and `frac` were converted to properly formatted L^AT_EX. Long product expansions were consolidated while retaining their distinct components and results, and expressions otherwise preserve the compact ordering of the source, for example `$\text{sc}(\Phi^*U)$` rather than adding an extra pair of parentheses.